

An Expression A Day

AEAD PDF Book

No. 801-900 / 100 entries

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This has never happened before.

こんなことなんて^{いま}今までなかったのに。

Konna koto nante ima made nakatta noni.

This has never happened before.

Variants

- こんなこと、^{いま}今までなかったのに。
This has never happened before.
- こんなこと、^{いま}今まで^お起きたことがなかったのに。
This kind of thing has never happened before.
- こんなこと、^{いま}今まで^{けいけん}経験したことがなかったのに。
I have never experienced anything like this before.

Adjusted Expression

^{いま}今まで、^おこんなことは起きたことがなかったのに。

Until now, this kind of thing had never happened.

Example

A 「^{ばす}バス、こないねえ」 B 「そうねえ、こんなことなんて^{いま}今までなかったのに」

A: The bus isn't coming, huh. B: Yeah, this has never happened before.

Notes

'Konna koto nante ima made nakatta noni.' is used to express surprise or confusion about something that has never happened before. 'Nante'

makes it more than a factual statement; it gives the feeling of 'I never expected something like this to happen.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- confusion about something unusual
- expression of an unexpected situation
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- unusual-situation expression
- unexpected-situation expression
- confusion expression

Sleeping peacefully.

すやすやと眠^{ねむ}っている。

Suyasuya to nemutte iru.

Sleeping peacefully.

Variants

- すやすやと眠^{ねむ}っている。

Sleeping peacefully.

- すやすや眠^{ねむ}っている。

Sleeping soundly.

- すやすやと寝^ねている。

Sound asleep.

Adjusted Expression

すやすやと眠^{ねむ}っています。

They are sleeping peacefully.

Example

A 「赤^{あか}ちゃん、眠^{ねむ}ってる？」 B 「いや、お父^{とう}さんの方^{ほう}が、すやすやと眠^{ねむ}ってるけど」

A: Is the baby asleep? B: No, actually, Dad is the one sleeping peacefully.

Notes

'Suyasuya' is an onomatopoeic expression for sleeping quietly and peacefully. It is often used for babies or children, but it can also describe

an adult sleeping comfortably. In the example, the funny point is that it is not the baby but the father who is sleeping peacefully.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of sleep state

expression of peaceful condition

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

onomatopoeia

sleep-state expression

peaceful-condition expression

Where did you learn that word?

そんなことば、どこで^{おぼ}覚えたの？

Sonna kotoba, doko de oboeta no?

Where did you learn that word?

Variants

- そんなことば、どこで^{おぼ}覚えたの？

Where did you learn that word?

- そんなことば、どこで^き聞いたの？

Where did you hear that word?

- そんなことば、どこで^し知ったの？

Where did you come across that word?

Adjusted Expression

そのようなことばを、どこで^{おぼ}覚えたのですか？

Where did you learn such a word?

Example

A 「^{ぱ ぱ}パパ、それ、^{こ ん ぶ ら て き}コンプラ的に^{あ う と}アウトじゃない？」 B 「^{れ い}レイちゃん、そんなことば、どこで^{おぼ}覚えたの？」

A: Dad, isn't that kind of a compliance issue? B: Rei-chan, where did you learn that phrase?

Notes

'Sonna kotoba, doko de oboeta no?' is used when someone uses a word or phrase that feels unexpected for them, such as a very grown-up expression from a child. 'Sonna kotoba' points not only to the word itself, but also to the surprise that this person used it. In the example, Rei-chan says 'konpura-teki ni auto,' a very adult-sounding phrase, so B reacts with surprise.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of surprise

asking where a word came from

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

surprise expression

word-origin-checking expression

colloquial expression

I hear that a lot.

よく^{みみ}耳にするね。

Yoku mimi ni suru ne.

I hear that a lot.

Variants

- よく^{みみ}耳にするね。

I hear that a lot.

- よく^き聞くね。

I often hear that.

- よく^{みみ}耳にする^{はなし}話だね。

That's something I hear often.

Adjusted Expression

よく^{みみ}耳にしますね。

I often hear that.

Example

^{さいきん}最近、よく^{みみ}耳にするね、この^{はなし}話。

I've been hearing about this a lot lately.

Notes

'Yoku mimi ni suru ne' is used when a topic or piece of information comes up often around you. Compared with 'kiku' (hear/listen), 'mimi ni suru' sounds less intentional; it suggests that the information naturally

reaches your ears. The final 'ne' adds the feeling that the speaker expects the listener to recognize the same situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of frequency

shared observation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

frequency expression

shared-observation expression

topic-response expression

It's hard to get a taxi, isn't it?

なかなか^{つか}掴まらないね、タクシー^{た く し ー}。

Nakanaka tsukamaranai ne, takushii.

It's hard to get a taxi, isn't it?

Variants

- なかなか^{つか}掴まらないね、タクシー^{た く し ー}。

It's hard to get a taxi, isn't it?

- なかなか^{つか}捕まらないね、タクシー^{た く し ー}。

It's difficult to get a taxi, isn't it?

- なかなか^{ひろ}拾えないね、タクシー^{た く し ー}。

It's not easy to hail a taxi, is it?

Adjusted Expression

タクシー^{た く し ー}がなかなか^{つか}掴まりませんね。

It's quite difficult to get a taxi, isn't it?

Example

A 「なかなか^{つか}掴まらないね、タクシー^{た く し ー}」 B 「駅前^{えきまえ}まで^{ある}歩くしかないね」

A: It's hard to get a taxi, isn't it? B: No choice but to walk to the station, then.

Notes

'Nakanaka tsukamaranai ne, takushii' is used when you are having trouble finding or hailing a taxi. Here, 'tsukamaru' does not mean

physically grabbing the taxi with your hand; it gives the metaphorical sense of getting hold of something you can use. 'Nakanaka' shows that something is not happening even though you are expecting it to happen. By placing 'takushii' at the end, the speaker first expresses the difficulty and then adds the topic in a natural spoken style. In the example, 'aruku shika nai ne' is rendered as 'No choice but to walk,' a short reaction-like phrase showing that walking is the only realistic option left.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of difficulty in transportation
- expression of a shared difficulty
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- transportation-difficulty expression
- shared-difficulty expression
- right-dislocation expression

Ah, this is it.

ああ、これこれ。

Aa, kore kore.

Ah, this is it.

Variants

- ああ、これこれ。

Ah, this is it.

- あ、これこれ。

Ah, this is the one.

- ああ、これだよ。

Ah, this is what I was looking for.

Adjusted Expression

ああ、これですね。

Ah, this is the one.

Example

A 「ねえ、これじゃない？ ほしかったの」 B 「ああ、これこれ」

A: Hey, isn't this the one you wanted? B: Ah, this is it.

Notes

'Aa, kore kore' is used when you find something just as expected, or when something brings back a familiar memory. It expresses satisfaction and recognition. For example, it can be used when you find a nostalgic taste, discover something you have been looking for for a long time, or

encounter a situation that feels just right. Even if the thing is far away, or even if the other person is holding it, the speaker says 'kore kore,' not 'are are' or 'sore sore,' to express the joy of finding exactly what they expected.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of finding what one was looking for
- recognition of a match
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- search-completion expression
- match-recognition expression
- recognition expression

Why don't you share a little?

ちよっと、^{ゆず}譲ったら？

Chotto, yuzuttara?

Why don't you share a little?

Variants

- ちよっと、^{ゆず}譲ったら？

Why don't you share a little?

- ^{すこ}少し、^{ゆず}譲ってみたら？

Why don't you let them have some?

- ^{すこ}少し、^{ゆず}譲ってみてはどう？

How about giving them a little?

Adjusted Expression

それぐらいは、^{ゆず}譲ってみてはいかがですか。

Why don't you let them have at least that much?

Example

A 「たくさん^も持っているんだから、ちよっと、^{ゆず}譲ったら？」 B 「え、だって」

A: You have a lot, so why don't you share a little? B: But...

Notes

'Chotto, yuzuttara?' is used to suggest that someone should share a little or let someone else have some, especially when they have a lot or are holding on to their share. Here, 'yuzuru' means giving up a small part of

what one has, or giving way a little. 'Chotto' makes the suggestion sound lighter than a direct command, but depending on the situation, it can also carry a mild note of reproach.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- suggestion to share or give way
- suggestion not to keep everything to oneself
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- sharing-suggestion expression
- not-keeping-everything expression
- gentle-prompt expression

No way, not that.

やだよ、そんなの。

Yada yo, sonna no.

No way, not that.

Variants

- やだよ、そんなの。

No way, not that.

- いやだよ、そんなの。

No, I don't want to.

- やだなあ、そんなの。

Ugh, I don't like that.

Adjusted Expression

そういうのは嫌いやです。

I don't like that kind of thing.

Example

A 「たまには、こんな色いろのきを着てみたら？」 B 「やだよ、そんなの」

A: Why don't you try wearing this color for a change? B: No way, not that.

Notes

'Yada yo, sonna no' is a casual spoken reaction used to reject a suggestion or something in front of you. 'Yada' is a shortened, casual form of 'iya da,' and it gives the refusal before any explanation. 'Sonna no' distances the speaker from the suggestion a little, as if saying 'that kind of thing.' It

sounds natural among friends or family, but depending on the person and situation, it can also sound strong or childish.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of refusal

reaction of dislike

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

refusal expression

dislike-reaction expression

reaction expression

I got carried away and messed up.

いい^き気になって、失敗^{しっぱい}しちゃった。

Ii ki ni natte, shippai shichatta.

I got carried away and messed up.

Variants

- いい^き気になって、失敗^{しっぱい}しちゃった。

I got carried away and messed up.

- 調子^{ちょうし}にのって、失敗^{しっぱい}しちゃった。

I got cocky and messed up.

- 自信過剰^{じしんかじょう}で、失敗^{しっぱい}しちゃった。

I was overconfident and messed up.

Adjusted Expression

調子^{ちょうし}に乗^のってしまい、失敗^{しっぱい}してしまいました。

I got carried away and ended up making a mistake.

Example

A 「うまくいったのにね」 B 「うん、いい^き気になって、失敗^{しっぱい}しちゃった」

A: Things were going well, too. B: Yeah, I got carried away and messed up.

Notes

'Ii ki ni natte, shippai shichatta' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker says they got carried away, became a little too confident, and

ended up making a mistake. Here, 'ii ki ni naru' does not simply mean feeling good; it suggests getting a bit carried away or letting success go to your head. 'Shichatta' is the casual form of 'shite shimatta,' and it adds a sense of regret or disappointment about what happened.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of self-reflection
- expression of failure due to overconfidence
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- self-reflection expression
- overconfidence-failure expression
- colloquial expression

I messed up, didn't I?

やっちゃいましたね。

Yacchaimashita ne.

I messed up, didn't I?

Variants

- やっちゃいましたね。

I messed up, didn't I?

- やってしまいましたね。

I really messed up, didn't I?

- やっちゃったね。

You messed up, huh.

Adjusted Expression

やってしまいましたね。

I really made a mistake, didn't I?

Example

A 「締切^{しめきり}、まだ間に合う^{まにあ}よね」 B 「え？ 昨日^{きのう}でしたよ」 A 「ああ、やっちゃいましたね」

A: The deadline is still okay, right? B: Huh? It was yesterday. A: Oh, I messed up, didn't I?

Notes

'Yacchaimashita ne' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker realizes that they have made a mistake or done something they should

not have done. It is often close to a self-deprecating 'I messed up, didn't I?' rather than a neutral report of failure. 'Yacchau' is the colloquial form of 'yatte shimau,' and here it means that the speaker has messed up, not that they have achieved something. The final 'ne' makes it sound as if the speaker is also checking or sharing that realization with the listener. For success or achievement, Japanese normally uses 'yarimashita,' not 'yacchaimashita.' For example, 'Yamamoto, yarimashita' or 'Yamamoto senshu, yarimashita' can be used playfully, even outside sports, as if the speaker were celebrating their own success in a live broadcast.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of having messed up reaction to a mistake colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar spoken mess-up expression mistake-reaction expression
colloquial expression

It was worth sticking it out.

ねば
粘ったかいがあったよ。

Nebatta kai ga atta yo.

It was worth sticking it out.

Variants

- ^{ねば}粘ったかいがあったよ。

It was worth sticking it out.

- ここまで^{ねば}粘ったかいがあったよ。

It was worth sticking it out this far.

- ^{がんば}頑張ったかいがあったよ。

It was worth the effort.

Adjusted Expression

ここまで^{ねば}粘ったかいがありました。

It was worth sticking it out this far.

Example

A 「とうとう^{かんせい}完成したね」 B 「うん、ここまで^{ねば}粘ったかいがあったよ」

A: We finally finished it. B: Yeah, it was worth sticking it out this far.

Notes

'Nebatta kai ga atta yo' is used when persistence has led to a satisfying result. 'Nebaru' means to keep going without giving up, especially when things do not work out right away. 'Kai ga atta' means that the effort or

patience was not wasted and led to a good result. In the example, 'koko made nebatta kai ga atta yo' expresses the feeling that sticking it out this far was worth it because it finally led to completion.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of the result of effort
- expression of a sense of achievement
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- effort-result expression
- achievement-sense expression
- colloquial expression

That's what I want.

それよ、それぞれ。

Sore yo, sore sore.

That's what I want.

Variants

- それよ、それぞれ。
That's what I want.
- そうそう、それぞれ。
Yes, that's it.
- それだよ、それぞれ。
That's exactly what I wanted.

Adjusted Expression

その通りとおです。それが望のぞましいです。

That's right. That is what I want.

Example

A 「今日きょうはみなさんよく働はたらいてくださったので、社長しゃちょうから特別手当とくべつてあてがででます」

B 「それよ、それぞれ、そうしないと」

A: Since everyone worked so hard today, the president is giving everyone a special bonus. B: That's what I want. That's how it should be.

Notes

'Sore yo, sore sore' is a casual spoken reaction used when someone's words or actions match what the speaker wanted, expected, or thought

should happen. It is not just simple agreement; it carries the feeling of 'That's what I wanted' or 'That's the right thing to do.' In the example, 'sou shinai to' adds the sense that this is how things should be.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

reaction to what one wanted

affirmative reaction

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

expected-response expression

affirmative-reaction expression

wanted-match expression

Why didn't you say that first?

どうして、それを^{さき}先に^い言ってくれないの？

Doushite, sore o saki ni itte kurenai no?

Why didn't you say that first?

Variants

- どうして、それを^{さき}先に^い言ってくれないの？
Why didn't you say that first?
- どうして、そんなこと^{さき}先に^い言ってくれないの？
Why didn't you mention that earlier?
- どうして、もっと^{はや}早く^い言ってくれなかったの？
Why didn't you tell me that sooner?

Adjusted Expression

どうして、それを^{さき}先に^い言ってくれなかったのですか？

Why didn't you tell me that earlier?

Example

A 「どうして、それを^{さき}先に^い言ってくれないの？」 B 「だって、^{だれ}誰も^き聞かなかったから」

A: Why didn't you say that first? B: Because nobody asked me.

Notes

'Doushite, sore o saki ni itte kurenai no?' is an immediate spoken reaction when important information is revealed too late. It is not simply asking for a reason. It also conveys the feeling that things could have turned out differently if the information had been given earlier. 'Saki ni' shows that the speaker is reacting not just to the information itself, but to the timing of when it was given. 'Itte kurenai no?' carries a mild tone of complaint rather than strong criticism. In the example, 'dare mo kikanakatta kara' means 'because nobody asked me.' It is different from 'dare mo kiite kurenakatta kara,' which means 'because nobody listened to me.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of dissatisfaction

reaction to delayed information sharing

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

dissatisfaction expression

delayed-information-reaction expression

timing-reaction expression

You could at least clean your own room.

へ や そうじ
部屋の掃除ぐらい、やってくれたっていいんじゃない。

Heya no souji gurai, yatte kureta tte ii n janai.

You could at least clean your own room.

Variants

- へ や そうじ
部屋の掃除ぐらい、やってくれたっていいんじゃない。
You could at least clean your own room.
- じぶん へ や そうじ
自分の部屋ぐらい、掃除してくれたっていいんじゃない。
You could at least tidy up your own room.
- じぶん へ や かたづ
自分の部屋ぐらい、片付けてくれたっていいんじゃない。
You could at least clean up after yourself.

Adjusted Expression

へ や そうじ
部屋の掃除ぐらいは、していただけますか。

Could you at least clean your own room?

Example

A「じゃ、あと、よろしく」 B「ちょっとまって。じぶん へ や そうじ
自分の部屋の掃除ぐらい、やってくれたっていいんじゃない」

A: Okay, you can take care of the rest. B: Wait a minute. You could at least clean your own room.

Notes

'Heya no souji gurai, yatte kureta tte ii n janai' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker feels that the other person should at least do something that is considered a minimum responsibility. 'Gurai' suggests that the task is not asking too much, and 'yatte kureta tte ii n janai' carries the feeling of 'You could at least do that.' Rather than giving a direct command, the speaker expresses mild dissatisfaction while implying that the responsibility naturally belongs to the listener.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression urging minimal responsibility

expression of mild dissatisfaction

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

responsibility-urging expression

minimum-expectation expression

dissatisfaction expression

Things did a complete 180.

180^ど度、^か変わっちゃいました。

180-do, kawacchaimashita.

Things did a complete 180.

Variants

- 180^ど度、^か変わっちゃいました。

It changed 180 degrees.

- 180^ど度も^か変わっちゃいました。

It changed completely.

- ^{ぜんぜんちが}全然違うものに^か変わっちゃいました。

It turned into something completely different.

Adjusted Expression

^{じょうきょう}状況が180^ど度も^か変わってしまいました。

The situation has changed completely.

Example

A 「なんか、^{ほうしん}方針が180^ど度、^か変わっちゃいましたね」 B 「しかたないよ、^{よさん}予算がないんだから」

A: Somehow, the policy has changed 180 degrees. B: It can't be helped; we don't have the budget.

Notes

'180-do, kawacchaimashita' is a casual spoken expression used when a situation, policy, opinion, or other matter has changed so drastically that it seems to have gone in the opposite direction. '180 degrees' is used metaphorically to mean 'a complete reversal.' 'Kawacchaimashita' is the colloquial form of 'kawatte shimaimashita,' often conveying surprise or disappointment about the unexpected change. In the example, the speaker is reacting to a major change in policy.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of a big change

expression of surprise

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

big-change expression

surprise expression

colloquial expression

No matter how you look at it, it's clear that...

どう^み見ても、...

Dou mite mo, ...

No matter how you look at it, it's clear that...

Variants

- どう^み見ても、...

No matter how you look at it, ...

- どの^みように見ても、...

Whichever way you look at it, ...

- どこ^みから見ても、...

Any way you look at it, ...

Adjusted Expression

どの^みように見ても、明^{あき}らかに...

No matter how you look at it, it's clearly ...

Example

A 「この^{けいかく}計画、^{ほんとう}本当に^{せいこう}成功すると思う？」 B 「いやあ、どう^み見ても、^{しっぱい}失敗するよ」

A: Do you really think this plan will succeed? B: No, no matter how you look at it, it's going to fail.

Notes

'Dou mite mo' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker presents a judgment as obvious, without explicitly saying 'clearly' or 'obviously.' It is not limited to visual observation. It is also used when the speaker feels that the conclusion follows from the overall situation. In English, 'No matter how you look at it' uses a general 'you,' not necessarily the specific listener. It means that no matter who looks at the situation, or from what angle, the same conclusion follows. In the example, the speaker presents the failure of the plan not merely as a personal opinion, but as something that anyone would conclude.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of an obvious fact

expression of emphasis

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

obvious-fact expression

emphasis expression

colloquial expression

At least, have some tea before you go.

せめて、お^{ちゃ}茶でも飲^のんでいかない？

Semete, ocha demo nonde ikanai?

At least, have some tea before you go.

Variants

- せめて、お^{ちゃ}茶でも飲^のんでいかない？
At least, have some tea before you go.
- せめて、お^{ちゃ}茶ぐらい飲^のんでいったら？
At least, stay for some tea.
- せめて、お^{ちゃ}茶でも飲^のんでいてよ。
Why don't you at least have some tea?

Adjusted Expression

せめて、お^{ちゃ}茶でも召^めしあがっていきませんか。

At least, would you like to have some tea before you go?

Example

A 「そろそろ帰^{かえ}らないと」 B 「そんなに忙^{いそ}がしいの？ せめて、お^{ちゃ}茶でも飲^のんでいかない？」

A: I should be heading back soon. B: Are you that busy? At least, have some tea before you go.

Notes

'Semete, ocha demo nonde ikanai?' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker really wishes the visitor could stay longer, but accepts that this may not be possible. 'Semete' softens the speaker's wish into a minimum request: if nothing else, at least have some tea before you go. 'Ocha demo' does not emphasize tea itself; rather, it is a gentle invitation to stay a little longer before leaving.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

minimum request after compromise

expression of hospitality

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

minimum-request expression

hospitality expression

compromise expression

I think I like this.

この^{あじ}味、^す好きかも。

Kono aji, suki kamo.

I think I like this.

Variants

- この^{あじ}味、^す好きかも。

I think I like this.

- この^{あじ}味、^す好きかもしれない。

I might like this.

- この^{あじ}味、^す好きかもね。

I think I might like this.

Adjusted Expression

この^{あじ}味、^す好きかもしれません。

I think I might like this.

Example

A 「これこれ、^た食べてみてみて」 B 「うん、この^{あじ}味、^す好きかも」

A: Here, try this. B: Yeah, I think I like this.

Notes

'Kono aji, suki kamo' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker suddenly realizes that they may like the taste of something.

'Kamo' does more than express possibility; it softens the speaker's

immediate discovery of a new preference. Rather than confidently saying 'I like it,' the speaker is reacting to the moment with the feeling, 'Oh, I think I like this.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- discovering a personal preference
- immediate realization
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- preference-discovery expression
- realization expression
- colloquial expression

If only it would...

ああ、こんなとき、...くれたら。

Aa, konna toki, ... kuretara.

If only it would...

Variants

- ああ、こんなとき、...くれたら。

If only it would...

- ああ、こんなとき、...してくれたら。

If only it would do that now.

- ああ、こんなとき、...してくれたらいいのに。

I wish it would do that now.

Adjusted Expression

こんなとき、^は晴れてくれたらいいのに。

I wish it would be sunny at a time like this.

Example

A 「とうとう、洗濯物^{せんたくもの}、いっぱいになっちゃったね」 B 「ああ、こんなとき、^は晴れてくれたら」

A: We've finally got a huge pile of laundry. B: Ah, if only it would be sunny.

Notes

'Aa, konna toki, ... kuretara' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker reacts to the immediate situation with a spontaneous wish.

Rather than expressing a long-term hope or plan, it voices a wish naturally prompted by what is happening at that moment. 'Aa' marks the speaker's reaction, 'konna toki' foregrounds the current situation, and '...kuretara' softly expresses the wish that something would happen to make the situation better.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- wish prompted by the situation
- expression of an immediate wish
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- situation-prompted wish expression
- immediate-wish expression
- colloquial expression

Not everything goes well.

なんでも^{う ま}上手くいくわけないって。

Nandemo umaku iku wake nai tte.

Not everything goes well.

Variants

- なんでも^{う ま}上手くいくわけないって。
Not everything goes well.
- なんでも^{じゅんちょう}順調にいくわけないって。
Not everything goes smoothly.
- なんでも^{おも}思いどおりにいくわけないって。
Not everything goes as planned.

Adjusted Expression

すべてが^{じゅんちょう}順調にいくわけではありません。

Not everything goes smoothly.

Example

A 「どうしよう。^{しっばい}失敗しちゃった」 B 「まあ、^{じんせい}人生、なんでも^{う ま}上手くいくわけないって」

A: What should I do? I messed up. B: Well, not everything goes well in life.

Notes

'Nandemo umaku iku wake nai tte' is a casual spoken expression used to help someone accept a failure realistically. It means that not everything can be expected to go well. 'Wake nai' strongly denies the idea that everything will work out, and 'tte' makes the line sound like the speaker is gently telling the listener, 'That's just how things are.' In the example, it is used not to blame the person who failed, but to calm them down a little.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression for calming someone down

realistic acceptance

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

comforting expression

realistic-recognition expression

failure-reaction expression

The only one who cares is me.

き じぶん
気にしてるのは自分だけ。

Kini shiteru no wa jibun dake.

You're the only one who cares.

Variants

- き じぶん
気にしてるのは自分だけ。

You're the only one who cares.

- しんばい じぶん
心配してるのは自分だけ。

You're the only one who's worried.

- なや じぶん
悩んでるのは自分だけ。

You're the only one who's bothered by it.

Adjusted Expression

き ひとじしん
気にしているのは、その人自身だけです。

The only one who is concerned about it is the person themselves.

Example

A 「今日のヘアスタイル、変？」 B 「いいよ。き じぶん
気にしてるのは自分だけだよ」

C 「そうだよ。みんな、そんなの^み見てもいないから」

A: Is my hairstyle weird today? B: It's fine. You're the only one who cares.

C: That's right. Nobody else is even looking.

Notes

'Kini shiteru no wa jibun dake' is a casual spoken expression used to reassure someone who is worrying too much about something. Here, 'jibun' does not simply mean 'myself.' Depending on the context, it may correspond to me, you, him, her, or another contextually relevant self. In this example, it refers to the listener, so the expression is translated as 'You're the only one who cares.' Rather than telling the person directly, 'Don't worry,' the speaker points out that other people are probably not paying attention to it at all. By presenting the concern as something only the person themselves is focusing on, the speaker gently eases the person's anxiety. The English title, 'The only one who cares is me,' should be understood as a pattern in which 'me' can be replaced by you, him, her, and so on.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression for reassuring someone

expression for easing unnecessary worry

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

reassuring expression

worry-easing expression

viewpoint-shift expression

jibun expression

context-dependent reference

I'm just repeating what I heard.

これ、^う受け^う売りだけど、

Kore, ukeuri dakedo,

I'm just repeating what I heard, but...

Variants

- これ、^う受け^う売りだけど、

I'm just repeating what I heard, but...

- これ、^き聞いた話だけど、

This is just something I heard, but...

- これ、^{ひと}人から^き聞いた話だけど、

This is just something I heard from someone, but...

Adjusted Expression

これは、^{ひと}人から^き聞いたことの^う受け^う売りですが、

This is only something I heard from someone else, but...

Example

A 「できないできないっていうのはまだまだ^{じぶん}自分に^の伸び^{しろ}代があるってことだよ」 B 「それって誰か^{だれ}の^う受け^う売りか何か？」 A 「バレた？」

A: Saying 'I can't do it' just means you still have room to grow. B: Isn't that just something you heard from someone? A: You caught me?

Notes

'Kore, ukeuri dakedo' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker is passing on words or ideas they heard from someone else, rather than presenting them as their own original thought. 'Ukeuri' does not simply indicate the source of information; it also suggests that the speaker is borrowing someone else's words, often with a slightly self-deprecating tone. 'Dakedo' works as a preface, softening the speaker's responsibility for what follows. In the example, A gives a motivational-sounding line, and B lightly teases A by suggesting that it may just be something A heard from someone else.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression indicating the source of information

expression indicating that it is not the speaker's own idea

expression for slightly softening responsibility for what is said

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

information-source expression

non-self-opinion expression

responsibility-softening expression

preface expression

Okay, let's move on.

じゃ、つぎ、いこう。

Ja, tsugi, ikou.

Okay, let's move on.

Variants

- じゃ、つぎ、いこう。
Okay, let's move on.
- じゃ、つぎにいこう。
All right, let's move on.
- じゃ、つぎの^{わだい}話題にいこう。
Okay, let's go on to the next one.

Adjusted Expression

では、^{つぎ}次の^{わだい}話題^{うつ}に移りましょう。

Let's move on to the next topic.

Example

A 「この^{もんだい}問題、できたね」 B 「うん、じゃ、つぎ、いこう」

A: We got this one. B: Okay, let's move on.

Notes

'Ja, tsugi, ikou' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker feels that the current topic or task has reached a natural stopping point and it is time to move on. 'Ja' signals a smooth transition from the previous situation, 'tsugi' refers to the next topic or task, and 'ikou' invites

everyone, including the speaker, to continue together. Rather than explicitly saying 'We're finished' or 'That's enough,' the speaker signals the completion of the current activity simply by proposing the next one.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression for moving on to the next topic or activity
- expression encouraging the next step
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- topic-transition expression
- activity-transition expression
- progression expression

What was I doing again?

なに ^{わす}
何してたんだっけ？ 忘れちゃった。

Nani shitetan dakke? Wasurechatta.

What was I doing again?

Variants

- なに ^{わす}
● 何してたんだっけ？ 忘れちゃった。

What was I doing again?

- なに
● 何をしていたんだっけ？

Now what was I doing?

- なに
● 何しようとしてたんだっけ？

I forgot what I was doing.

Adjusted Expression

じぶん ^{なに} ^{わす}
自分が何をしていたのか、忘れてしまいました。

I forgot what I was doing.

Example

A 「なに ^{わす}
何してたんだっけ？ 忘れちゃった」 B 「よくある、よくある」

A: What was I doing again? B: Happens all the time.

Notes

'Nani shitetan dakke? Wasurechatta.' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker suddenly realizes they have forgotten what they were doing and tries to recall it. The ending '... dakke?' expresses an attempt to

search one's memory, while 'wasurechatta' is the colloquial form of 'wasurete shimatta,' lightly acknowledging the momentary lapse of memory. It is a very common expression in everyday conversation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of trying to remember
- expression of momentary forgetfulness
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- recall expression
- forgetfulness expression
- realization expression

There's nothing else like it.

ほか あじ
他では味わえない。

Hoka de wa ajiwaenai.

There's nothing else like it.

Variants

- ほか あじ
他では味わえない。

You can't experience it anywhere else.

- ほか たいけん
他では体験できない。

You can't taste it anywhere else.

- ほか けいけん
他では経験できない。

You can't have this experience anywhere else.

Adjusted Expression

ほか あじ
他の場所では味わうことができません。

You cannot experience it in any other place.

Example

A 「この料理、おいしいね」 B 「ほか あじ
他では味わえないよ」

A: This dish is amazing. B: There's nothing else like it.

Notes

'Hoka de wa ajiwaenai' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker feels that something is truly unique after comparing it with other places or experiences. 'Ajiwau' literally means 'to taste,' but it also

refers to fully appreciating or enjoying an experience, atmosphere, or emotion. Rather than simply stating that something is unavailable elsewhere, the expression highlights its distinctive value.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression emphasizing uniqueness
- expression indicating a special experience
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- uniqueness expression
- special-experience expression

It's totally obvious, isn't it?

ば れ ば れ
バレバレですね。

Barebare desu ne.

It's totally obvious, isn't it?

Variants

- ば れ ば れ
• バレバレですね。

It's totally obvious, isn't it?

- み み
• 見え見えですね。

We can see right through it, can't we?

- かく
• 隠してもすぐわかりますね。

Anyone can tell, can't they?

Adjusted Expression

かく あき
隠そうとしていることが明らかですね。

It is clear what they are trying to hide.

Example

A 「ば れ ば れ
バレバレですね」 B 「そうだね。かく む だ
隠しても無駄だったね」

A: It's totally obvious, isn't it? B: Yeah. There was no point trying to hide it.

Notes

'Barebare desu ne' is a casual spoken expression used when something being hidden, such as a secret or someone's real intention, is completely

obvious to others. 'Bareru' means that something concealed becomes known. The repeated form 'barebare' emphasizes that the attempt to hide it has failed so completely that anyone can see through it. The ending 'desu ne' adds a sense of confirming and sharing that judgment with the listener.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression indicating that something concealed has been seen through
- expression emphasizing obviousness
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- exposed-secret expression
- seeing-through expression
- obviousness expression

A golden opportunity.

ぜっこう ち ゃ ん す
絶好のチャンス

Zekkou no chansu

A golden opportunity.

Variants

- ぜっこう ち ゃ ん す
● 絶好のチャンス

A golden opportunity.

- ぜっこう き かい
● 絶好の機会

A perfect opportunity.

- ぜっこう た い み ん ぐ
● 絶好のタイミング

Perfect timing.

Adjusted Expression

ぜっこう き かい
絶好の機会です。

It is an excellent opportunity.

Example

A 「ゆき じょうたい てんき げれんで こ
雪の状態もいいし、天気もいいし、ゲレンデも混んでないよ。どう？」 B
「うん、す きー ぜっこう ち ゃ ん す
スキーするには、絶好のチャンスだね」

A: The snow is good, the weather is nice, and the slopes aren't crowded.
What do you think? B: Yeah, it's a golden opportunity to go skiing.

Notes

'Zekkou no chansu' is used when the conditions for doing something are exceptionally favorable. 'Zekkou' means that the situation could hardly be better, while 'chansu' refers to an opportunity to take action. In the example, the snow, weather, and lack of crowds all make it an excellent opportunity to go skiing.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression indicating an excellent opportunity

expression indicating favorable conditions for action

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

opportunity expression

chance expression

action-starting expression

Mmm, something smells good.

ああ、いい^{にお}匂い。

Aa, ii nioi.

Mmm, something smells good.

Variants

- ああ、いい^{にお}匂い。

Mmm, something smells good.

- ああ、いい^{かお}香り。

Ah, what a lovely aroma.

- ああ、なんていい^{にお}匂い。

Mmm, what a wonderful smell.

Adjusted Expression

とてもいい^{かお}香りがしますね。

There is a very pleasant aroma.

Example

A 「ああ、いい^{にお}匂い」 B 「何^{なん}の^{にお}匂いだろうね」

A: Mmm, something smells good. B: I wonder what it is.

Notes

'Aa, ii nioi' is a casual spoken reaction that comes out at the moment a pleasant smell reaches the speaker. 'Aa' marks the rise of sensory awareness, while 'ii nioi' shows that the smell has been received as

pleasant. The expression can be used even when the speaker does not yet know what the smell is or where it is coming from. In the example, both speakers notice the pleasant smell, but its source is still unknown.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- immediate reaction to a pleasant smell
- sensory discovery
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- smell-reaction expression
- sensory-discovery expression
- pleasant-smell expression

Lavender, maybe?

らべんだー
ラベンダーかなあ。

Rabendaa kanaa.

Lavender, maybe?

Variants

- らべんだー
ラベンダーかなあ。

Lavender, maybe?

- らべんだー かの
ラベンダーの香りかな。

I wonder if it's lavender.

- らべんだー にお
ラベンダーの匂いかな。

Could it be the scent of lavender?

Adjusted Expression

らべんだー かの
ラベンダーの香りでしょうか。

Could it be the scent of lavender?

Example

A 「ああ、いい匂い。何だろう」 B 「らべんだーかなあ」

A: Mmm, something smells good. I wonder what it is. B: Lavender, maybe?

Notes

'Rabendaa kanaa' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker notices a smell and thinks that lavender may be its source. The speaker

does not explicitly say 'smell' or 'scent,' because the perceived smell is already present in the immediate context. 'Kanaa' does not necessarily ask the listener for an answer; here, it presents the speaker's emerging guess as a thought spoken aloud.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression for guessing the identity of a smell
- expression proposing a candidate for something perceived
- self-directed expression
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- smell-guessing expression
- candidate-proposing expression
- self-directed expression

A salad place.

さ ら だ みせ
サラダの店

Sarada no mise

A salad place.

Variants

- さ ら だ みせ
サラダの店

A salad place.

- さ ら だ だ みせ
サラダだけを出す店

A restaurant that only serves salads.

- さ ら だ みせ
サラダのお店

A restaurant specializing in salads.

Adjusted Expression

さ ら だ ちゅうしん ていきょう いんしょくてん
サラダを中心に提供する飲食店

A restaurant that mainly serves salads.

Example

A 「このお店、ちょっと変わってるね」 B 「そう、ここが噂のサラダの店だよ」

A: This place is a little unusual. B: Yes. This is that salad place everyone has been talking about.

Notes

"Sarada no mise" is a casual expression that briefly indicates the type or character of a restaurant. Here, "no" links the two nouns, "salad" and "restaurant," without specifying their exact relationship. Depending on the situation, the phrase may refer to a restaurant that serves salads, is known for salads, mainly offers salads, or specializes in salads. It might even be a restaurant that serves only salads. Thus, even in the simple noun-no-noun pattern, the relationship created by "no" can be remarkably flexible.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression identifying a restaurant by its food

expression briefly indicating the character of a restaurant

expression leaving the relationship between two nouns to the situation

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

noun-no-noun

no

restaurant

I shouldn't have done that.

よけい
余計なことしちゃった。

Yokei na koto shichatta.

I shouldn't have done that.

Variants

- よけい 余計なことしちゃった。
I shouldn't have done that.
- よけい 余計なことしちゃったかも。
Maybe I shouldn't have done that.
- よけい 余計なことをしてしまった。
I did something I should not have.

Adjusted Expression

よけい
余計なことをしてしまいました。

I did something I should not have.

Example

A 「ゆうくん、自分ひとりで作りたかったのかなあ」 B 「そうね、よけい 余計なことしちゃったかもね」

A: I wonder if Yuu-kun wanted to make it on his own. B: Yeah, maybe we shouldn't have done that.

Notes

'Yokei na koto shichatta' immediately re-evaluates a completed action as something that would have been better left undone. The action itself is not stated because it is already present in the immediate situation and is retrospectively characterized as 'yokei na koto.' 'Shichatta' is the colloquial form of 'shite shimatta'; here, together with 'yokei na koto,' it presents the completed action through the speaker's immediate self-assessment.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately reassessing one's own action

immediate self-evaluation after an action

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

self-evaluation

reflection expression

post-action evaluation

Tonight, it's curry rice.

こんや か れ ー ら い す
今夜はね、カレーライス。

Konya wa ne, kareraisu.

Tonight, it's curry rice.

Variants

- ^{こんや}今夜はね、^{か れ ー ら い す}カレーライス。

Tonight, it's curry rice.

- ^{こんや}今夜はね、^{か れ ー}カレーだよ。

Tonight, it's curry.

- ^{こんや}今夜はね、^{か れ ー ら い す}カレーライスにするよ。

Tonight, we're having curry rice.

Adjusted Expression

^{こんや} ^{ゆうしょく} ^な ^{か れ ー ら い す}
今夜の夕食はカレーライスです。

Tonight's dinner is curry rice.

Example

A 「^{きょう} ^{なに}今日は何？」 B 「^{こんや} ^{か れ ー ら い す}今夜はね、カレーライス」

A: What are we having today? B: Tonight, it's curry rice.

Notes

'Konya wa ne, kareraisu' presents tonight as the relevant frame and then gives only the name of the dish. Nothing corresponding to 'dinner is,' 'we are having,' or 'I am making' is stated, because the shared situation

supplies that relation. In the example, the question uses 'today,' while the answer uses 'tonight.' Conversation does not require the speaker to repeat the other person's time expression mechanically; the speaker may shift the focus to the range needed for the answer. Here, 'ne' lightly holds the listener's attention while the speaker presents tonight as the relevant frame.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression presenting tonight as the relevant frame and naming the dish
- expression ending with the name of the dish without stating a predicate
- expression adjusting the time frame within a conversation
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- topic presentation
- noun ending
- frame adjustment
- dinner expression

It has a nice mouthfeel.

くちあ
口当たりがいいねえ。

Kuchi atari ga ii nee.

It has a nice mouthfeel.

Variants

- くちあ
● 口当たりがいいねえ。

It has a nice mouthfeel.

- くちあ やわ
● 口当たりが柔らかいねえ。

It has a soft texture.

- くちあ なめ
● 口当たりが滑らかでいいねえ。

It has a smooth and pleasant texture.

Adjusted Expression

この料理はくちあがよいですね。

This dish has a nice mouthfeel.

Example

A 「このスープ、くちあがいいねえ」 B 「うん、なめ滑らかでおいしいね」

A: This soup has a nice mouthfeel. B: Yeah, it's smooth and delicious.

Notes

'Kuchi atari ga ii nee' is a casual spoken expression that describes the pleasant sensation or taste of food or drink when it enters the mouth.

'Kuchi atari' refers to how food or drink feels in the mouth, and 'ii nee'

positively evaluates that sensation. In the example, the smoothness and deliciousness of the soup are conveyed simultaneously.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression evaluating the mouthfeel of food or drink
- expression emphasizing the pleasantness of texture
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- texture-evaluation expression
- mouthfeel expression
- taste expression

What? You're going to do that?

えっ！そんなことするの？

E! Sonna koto suru no?

What? You're going to do that?

Variants

- えっ！そんなことするの？

What? You're going to do that?

- えっ！^{ほんとう}本当にそんなことするの？

What? You're really going to do that?

- えっ！まさかそんなことするの？

What? You wouldn't actually do that, would you?

Adjusted Expression

えっ、そんなことをするのですか？

What? Are you really going to do that?

Example

A 「ねえ、そこの^ちョ^こレ^ート、とって、^かレ^ーに^いれるから」 B 「えっ！そんなことするの？」

A: Hey, pass me that chocolate. I'm going to put it in the curry. B: What? You're going to do that?

Notes

'E! Sonna koto suru no?' is a casual expression that immediately reacts with surprise and seeks confirmation when another person proposes an

unexpected action. 'E!' occurs before any explanation or considered judgment and presents the speaker's immediate response. 'Sonna koto' points to the action just mentioned without describing it again, treating it as already shared within the situation. 'Suru no?' does not merely ask about a plan; it presents the action back to the other person for confirmation, with surprise or disbelief. In the example, the speaker does not repeat the idea of putting chocolate in the curry but immediately refers to it as 'sonna koto.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression immediately reacting with surprise to an action proposed by another person
- expression referring back to the action just mentioned and seeking confirmation
- expression conveying surprise and disbelief at the same time
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- surprise expression
- confirmation expression
- deictic expression
- immediate reaction

Oh, if you can't, just say so.

あ、無理^{むり}なら無理^{むり}と。

A, muri nara muri to.

Oh, if you can't, just say so.

Variants

- あ、無理^{むり}なら無理^{むり}と。
Oh, if you can't, just say so.
- あ、無理^{むり}なら無理^{むり}って^い言って。
Oh, if you can't, just tell me.
- あ、無理^{むり}なら無理^{むり}でいいから。
Oh, if you can't, that's okay.

Adjusted Expression

あ、無理^{むり}なら無理^{むり}だと言^いってください。

If you are unable to do it, please let me know.

Example

A 「手^て伝^つってほしいんだけど、無理^{むり}なら無理^{むり}と言^いってもらってもいいからね」

B 「うん、大^{だい}丈^{じょう}夫^ぶだよ」

A: I'd like you to help me, but if you can't, it's okay to say so. B: Yeah, I can.

Notes

'A, muri nara muri to' is a casual expression added after a request or proposal to give the other person immediate permission to decline. 'A' signals that the speaker has just remembered an important qualification and is quickly reducing the pressure created by the request. Repeating 'muri' indicates that the listener may state directly that something is not possible. The final 'to' marks the quoted content, while a verb such as 'itte' or 'tsutaete' remains unspoken because the situation makes it recoverable. The utterance therefore communicates the requested response without completing the sentence.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately giving the other person permission to decline

expression reducing the pressure created by a request

expression ending with the quotative particle 'to' while leaving 'say' unspoken

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

request mitigation

permission to decline

unfinished utterance

ellipsis

Oh, that's a bit iffy.

あ、それ^{びみょう}微妙。

A, sore bimyou.

Oh, that's a bit iffy.

Variants

- あ、それ^{びみょう}微妙。

Oh, that's a bit iffy.

- あ、それは^{びみょう}微妙だね。

Yeah, that's not so great.

- あ、それは^{びみょう}微妙かもね。

Hmm, I'm not sure about that.

Adjusted Expression

それは^{すこ}少し^{びみょう}微妙ですね。

I'm not sure that works very well.

Example

A 「ええと、この^{でざいん}デザイン、^{かたち}形はいいんだけど、^{いろ}色がねえ」 B 「うん、^{びみょう}微妙」

A: Well, I like the shape of this design, but the color... B: Yeah, it's a bit iffy.

Notes

'A, sore bimyou' is a casual expression that gives an immediate negative evaluation of something just presented. In this use, 'bimyou' does not simply mean that something lies somewhere between good and bad, nor

does it mean 'subtle.' The speaker actually feels that it is not very good or does not work well, but uses 'bimyou' to avoid sounding too direct or rude. 'A' marks the speaker's immediate reaction, while 'sore' points to the thing just mentioned without describing it again. The particles and copula that could appear in 'sore wa bimyou da' are also left unspoken, leaving only the short evaluation. In the example, the color is being judged negatively, but the speaker avoids directly calling it bad.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression immediately giving a negative evaluation of something just presented
- expression softening criticism instead of directly saying that something is not good
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- immediate evaluation
- negative evaluation
- softened criticism
- deictic expression

I'm not sure that's appropriate.

いかがなものかとおもいます。

Ikaga na mono ka to omoimasu.

I'm not sure that's appropriate.

Variants

- いかがなものかとおもいます。

I'm not sure that's appropriate.

- それは、いかがなものかとおもいます。

I have some reservations about that.

- それは少しどうかとおもいます。

I don't think that's a good idea.

Adjusted Expression

この点には問題があります。～のように修正するのがよいとおもいます。

I have a concern about this point. I suggest revising it as follows.

Example

A 「この案で来月から始めたいとおもいます」 B 「それは、いかがなものかとおもいます」 A 「どの点に問題がありますか」

A: We'd like to start next month with this proposal. B: I'm not sure that's appropriate. A: Which part do you think is problematic?

Notes

'Ikaga na mono ka to omoimasu' is used in meetings and similar settings to indicate a negative position without directly saying 'I oppose it' or 'It is not good.' Although its form appears to ask how something should be evaluated, it often functions as a signal that the proposal should not proceed as it stands. Used by itself, however, it does not tell the other person what the problem is or how the proposal could be improved. When repeatedly used without specific reasons, it may be understood as rejection of the proposer rather than criticism of the proposal. Learners need to recognize the opposition conveyed by this expression when they hear it, but they are advised not to use it themselves. It may disadvantage the speaker by making them sound unable to give a concrete opinion or personally opposed to another participant. When disagreeing, it is better to identify the specific concern and, where possible, suggest an improvement.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression indicating opposition without directly saying so

expression sometimes used to stop a proposal without giving a specific reason

expression that learners need to understand when they hear it

expression that learners are advised not to use themselves

Tags EN

immediate grammar

meeting expression

indirect negation

vague opposition

not recommended for use

receptive understanding

It just doesn't fit.

どうもしっくりこない。

Doumo shikkuri konai.

It just doesn't fit.

Variants

- どうもしっくりこない。
It just doesn't fit.
- どうもしっくりこないなあ。
It just doesn't seem to fit.
- どうもしっくりこない^{かん}感じだなあ。
Something about it doesn't feel right.

Adjusted Expression

どうもしっくりきません。

It does not seem to fit.

Example

A 「この色、キッチンとしてはいいんだけど、玄関としてはねえ」 B 「うん、どうもしっくりこない」

A: This color works well in the kitchen, but for the entrance... B: Yeah, it just doesn't fit.

Notes

'Doumo shikkuri konai' is a casual expression used when one thing does not fit naturally with another thing, place, role, idea, or explanation and

therefore fails to form a satisfactory whole. It does not simply mean that the speaker feels personally uncomfortable. Rather, it evaluates the relationship or combination between two or more elements as not fitting properly. 'Doumo' indicates that something seems wrong even when the speaker cannot yet identify or explain the precise problem. In the example, the color itself is not being judged as bad. It works in the kitchen, but it does not fit naturally with the entrance.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression indicating that one thing does not fit well with another
- expression immediately stating that a combination does not form a satisfactory whole
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- combination evaluation
- fit expression
- mismatch expression

This one extra step makes all the difference.

このひと手間が、おおちが
大違い。

Kono hitotema ga, oochigai.

This one extra step makes all the difference.

Variants

- このひと手間が、おおちが
大違い。

This one extra step makes all the difference.

- このひと手間をかけるだけで、おおちが
大違い。

Just taking this extra step makes all the difference.

- このひと手間で、おおちが
大違い。

This little extra touch makes a big difference.

Adjusted Expression

このひと手間をかけることで、仕上がりが大きく違います。

Taking this one extra step makes a significant difference to the result.

Example

A 「野菜の切り方で味ってこんなに違うんだ」 B 「そう、このひと手間が、
おおちが大違い！」

A: The way you cut the vegetables makes such a difference in taste. B:
Exactly—this one extra step makes all the difference!

Notes

'Kono hitotema ga, oochigai' is a casual expression indicating that adding one specific step or touch to an ordinary process can substantially change the result. 'Hitotema' does not refer to effort in general. It refers to a concrete additional step, such as changing the way something is cut, adding preparation, or making a final adjustment. 'Kono' points to the particular step that has just been performed or demonstrated. 'Oochigai' presents the large difference produced by that step. Rather than completing a sentence such as 'this extra step produces a big difference,' the speaker places 'this one extra step' and 'a big difference' together, making the relation between the action and its result immediate and emphatic. In the example, the way the vegetables are cut is evaluated as one small additional step that produces a noticeable difference in taste. For more on the act of adding an extra step, see No.199 'Hitotema kakeru.' This entry focuses on evaluating the effect of a specific extra step that has just been demonstrated.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression indicating that one additional step substantially changes the result

expression evaluating the effect of a specific extra step just demonstrated

expression presenting the result with the noun 'oochigai' without stating a full predicate

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

extra step

evaluation of ingenuity

difference in outcome

noun ending

I've been really into it, so...

はまってて。

Hamattete.

I've been really into it, so...

Variants

- はまってる。

I'm hooked.

- はまってるね。

You're really into it, aren't you?

- はまってるなあ。

I'm really into this.

Adjusted Expression

それに^{むちゅう}夢中になっています。

I'm absorbed in it.

Example

A 「最近^{さいきん}、大学^{だいがく}、来^きてないよね？」 B 「いや、来^きてるけど、部活^{ぶかつ}にはまってて」

A: You haven't been around campus lately, have you? B: No, I have. I've just been really into my club, so...

Notes

'Hamatteru' is the colloquial form of 'hamatte iru.' It expresses more than simply liking something: the person has been drawn into it, keeps

engaging with it, and is directing considerable time or attention toward it. The target is commonly marked by 'ni,' as in 'geemu ni hamatteru' or 'bukatsu ni hamatteru,' but it can be left unspoken when it is already shared in the immediate situation. Depending on the context, 'hamatteru ne' may describe another person's involvement, while 'hamatteru naa' may reflect on the speaker's own state or someone else's. In the example, 'bukatsu ni hamattete' ends with the connective 'te.' The speaker presents the reason and leaves the rest unstated because the preceding exchange makes the connection understandable. 'I'm hooked' works well when the involvement feels strong, while 'I'm really into it' is often more neutral and natural for activities such as a university club.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression indicating an ongoing state of being strongly drawn into something
- expression leaving the subject or object unspoken when it is already shared in the situation
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- absorption expression
- ongoing state
- omitted object
- unfinished utterance

I found out it's...

かい
3階でした

Sankai deshita.

I found out that it's on the 3rd floor.

Variants

- 3階でした

I found out that it's on the 3rd floor.

- 3階にありました

It was on the 3rd floor.

- 3階だった

It turned out to be on the 3rd floor.

Adjusted Expression

かい
3階でした。

I found it is on the 3rd floor.

Example

A 「田中先生の研究室は？」 B 「ちょっと待ってください。あ、ちょっと調べ
ますね。あ、ここじゃなくて3階でした。その階段からどうぞ」

A: Where is Professor Tanaka's office? B: Just a moment. Let me check.
Oh, it's not on this floor. I found out that it's on the 3rd floor. Please use
the stairs over there.

Notes

'Sankai deshita' is a colloquial expression used to report a fact immediately after it has been discovered through checking or investigation. Although 'deshita' is formally a past-tense form, it does not mean that the office used to be on the 3rd floor. Rather, it presents the information as the result of a completed act of checking. If the speaker already knew the location and was simply giving directions, 'Sankai desu' would normally be used. In the example, B checks the location of Professor Tanaka's office and then reports that it is currently on the 3rd floor.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately reporting a fact discovered through checking or investigation

expression reporting the result of checking in response to a preceding question

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

fact reporting

discovery expression

conversation response

confirmation result

That was close.

あぶ
危なかつたあ！

Abunakattaa!

That was close!

Variants

- あぶ 危なかつたあ！

That was close!

- あぶ 危なかつたねえ。

That was a close one.

- あぶ 危なかつたなあ。

That could have been bad.

Adjusted Expression

あぶ
危ないところでした。

That was a close call.

Example

A 「おっと、あぶ 危なかつたあ...」 B 「パソコン、だいじょうぶ？」

A: Whoa, that was close... B: Is the computer okay?

Notes

'Abunakattaa' is a casual immediate reaction uttered just after danger or failure has narrowly been avoided. It does not merely report that a past situation was dangerous. It looks back on the preceding moment as one

in which a bad outcome almost occurred. The speaker does not state exactly what nearly happened, because the immediate situation makes it understandable to the listener. Lengthening the final sound in 'abunakattaa' conveys the release of tension and relief after the near miss. In the example, B understands without further explanation that something nearly happened to the computer and immediately checks its condition.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- immediate reaction after danger or failure has narrowly been avoided
- expression conveying relief after a near miss
- expression leaving the narrowly avoided event unspoken because it is shared in the situation
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- immediate reaction
- danger avoided
- near miss
- relief expression

That's the spirit.

それでこそ。

Sore de koso.

That's the spirit.

Variants

- それでこそ。
That's the spirit.
- それでこそだね。
Now that's what I'm talking about.
- それでこそだよ。
That's more like it.

Adjusted Expression

そのような姿勢^{しせい}こそ、あなたに期待^{きたい}していたものです。

That is exactly the attitude I expected from you.

Example

A 「ここまできたら、最後^{さいご}までやりますよ」 B 「それでこそ」

A: Now that we've come this far, I'm going to see it through to the end. B:
That's the spirit.

Notes

'Sore de koso' is a casual expression that immediately evaluates the other person's preceding words or action as fitting the resolve, attitude, or quality expected of that person or role. 'Sore' points to what has just been

said or done, while 'koso' gives it strong focus as exactly what was hoped for. The expression may be completed as 'sore de koso kimi da,' 'sore de koso puro da,' or 'sore de koso anata rashii,' but the final evaluation can remain unspoken when it is recoverable from the immediate situation. In the example, B recognizes A's declaration to continue to the end as exactly the determined attitude expected of them.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression evaluating the other person's immediately preceding words or action as meeting expectations

expression briefly recognizing the resolve or quality expected of that person or role

expression leaving the following evaluation unspoken

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

immediate evaluation

expectation fulfilled

evaluation of attitude

ellipsis

It feels right.

しっくりくる。

Shikkuri kuru.

It feels right.

Variants

- しっくりくる。

It feels right.

- しっくりきます。

It fits well.

- しっくりきた。

That really works.

Adjusted Expression

よくなじんでいます。

It fits well.

Example

A 「この^{へや}部屋の^{かーてん}カーテンに、これどう？」 B 「うん、しっくりくるね。^{べんきょう}勉強できそう」

A: How about this for the curtains in this room? B: Yeah, it feels right. I think I could study well in here.

Notes

'Shikkuri kuru' is a casual expression used when one thing fits naturally with a place, role, idea, explanation, or another element and the

combination forms a satisfactory whole. It does not simply evaluate the item itself as good. Rather, it evaluates the relationship between two or more elements as fitting together well. 'Shikkuri' describes a state of natural and comfortable fit, while 'kuru' presents that fit as something that is felt or recognized. In the example, B is not evaluating the curtains in isolation but judging that they fit naturally with the room. This also makes the room feel like a place where studying would be comfortable. For the negative form, see No.838, 'Doumo shikkuri konai.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression indicating that one thing fits naturally with a place, role, idea, or other element
- expression immediately evaluating a combination as forming a satisfactory whole
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- combination evaluation
- fit expression
- immediate evaluation

That's pretty lame.

しょぼい

Shoboi.

That's pretty lame.

Variants

- しょぼい。

That's pretty lame.

- しょぼいなあ。

That's underwhelming.

- しょぼいねえ。

That's not much.

Adjusted Expression

きたい期待していたほどのないよう内容ではありませんでした。

It was not as impressive as I had expected.

Example

A 「予告は面白^{よこく}そうだったのにね」 B 「うん、しょぼい^{えいが}映画」

A: The trailer looked interesting, though. B: Yeah, it was a pretty lame movie.

Notes

'Shoboi' is a clearly derogatory expression that dismisses someone or something as lame, meager, or unimpressive. It may be used jokingly among close friends, classmates, or family members, where insults can

function as shared banter. That does not make the expression neutral; outside such relationships, it is plainly rude.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression evaluating something as less impressive or substantial than expected
- expression immediately pointing out that something looks meager, weak, or unimpressive
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- negative evaluation
- underwhelming
- meager evaluation
- immediate evaluation

Oh no...

あーあ...

Aaa...

Oh no...

Variants

- あーあ...

Oh no...

- あーあ、^{ざんねん}残念だなあ。

Aw, that's too bad.

- あーあ、やっちゃったね。

Oh dear, you did it now.

Adjusted Expression

^{ざんねん}
残念なことになりました。

That is unfortunate.

Example

A 「あ、^わ割っちゃった」 B 「あーあ...」

A: Oh, I broke it. B: Oh no...

Notes

'Aaa...' is a casual immediate reaction of dismay when an undesirable result has just occurred. Rather than describing the event by saying that it is unfortunate, the speaker directly voices their reaction to the outcome. It can express sympathy when something unfortunate happens

to another person, but when the result was caused by that person's carelessness or action, it may also carry mild exasperation or reproach, similar to 'Look what happened.' In the example, B does not restate what is regrettable but responds directly to the visible result that something has been broken.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression immediately showing dismay after an undesirable result occurs
- expression that may convey mild exasperation or reproach about what has happened
- expression reacting without explicitly stating what is regrettable
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- dismay expression
- reaction to an outcome
- mild exasperation
- unfinished utterance

Oh, brother.

やれやれ。

Yare yare.

Oh, brother.

Variants

- やれやれ。

Oh, brother.

- やれやれ、^{つか}疲れたなあ。

Phew, I'm exhausted.

- やれやれ、^{たいへん}大変だった。

Phew, that was tough.

Adjusted Expression

^{こま}困りましたね。

This is troublesome.

Example

A 「まだ^{しけん}試験、4つあるよ」 B 「やれやれ、^{さき}^{なが}先は長いなあ」

A: We still have four more exams. B: Oh, brother. We still have a long way to go.

Notes

'Yare yare' is a casual, sigh-like reaction that voices weariness, exasperation, mild disbelief, or relief, depending on the situation. It may be uttered when a troublesome situation has arisen, when the same

problem has happened again, or when a difficult task has finally ended. Its English equivalent therefore varies with context and may be 'Oh, brother,' 'Phew,' or 'Here we go again.' In the example, B reacts with weariness on hearing that four exams still remain.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression voicing weariness or exasperation about a troublesome situation
- expression that can also convey relief just after a difficulty has ended
- expression that may show mild exasperation at someone's action or a repeated problem
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- weariness expression
- exasperation expression
- relief expression
- mild exasperation
- sigh-like expression

That was a close call.

かんいっばつ
間一髪！

Kan'ippatsu!

That was a close call.

Variants

- ^{かんいっばつ}間一髪！

That was a close call.

- ^{かんいっばつ たす}間一髪で助かった！

That was a close one.

- ^{かんいっばつ せーふ}間一髪でセーフ！

That could have been bad.

Adjusted Expression

^{あぶ}危ないところでした。

That was a close call.

Example

A 「^{あぶ}危なかったあ！^{かんいっばつ}間一髪だったよ」 B 「^{ぼ そ こん ぶ じ}パソコン、無事でよかったね」

A: Whew, that was close! That was really a close call. B: I'm glad the computer is okay.

Notes

'Kan'ippatsu!' is an idiomatic expression meaning that danger or failure was avoided by the narrowest possible margin. Rather than expressing

the speaker's relief, it briefly evaluates the fact that the outcome was only just avoided. The exact danger is usually left unstated because it is obvious from the immediate situation. Unlike No.842, 'Abunakattaa!', which primarily voices the speaker's relief after a near miss, 'Kan'ippatsu!' focuses on the objective fact that the danger was avoided by only a tiny margin. For this reason, it can be used about oneself, another person, or an event. In the example, the speaker looks back on nearly dropping the computer and characterizes the incident as having been avoided by only the narrowest margin.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression evaluating a danger or failure as having been avoided by the narrowest margin

expression immediately commenting on the fact that a near miss has occurred

expression leaving the narrowly avoided event unspoken because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

immediate evaluation

danger avoided

near miss

idiomatic expression

Wait, no.

あ、^{ちが}違う。

A, chigau.

Wait, no.

Variants

- あ、^{ちが}違う。

Wait, no.

- あ、^{ちが}違った。

Oh, no.

- いや、^{ちが}違う。

No, that's not right.

- ^{ちが}違う ^{ちが}違う。

No, no.

Adjusted Expression

^{ちが}違いました。

That was incorrect.

Example

A 「このボタンを押して...あ、^{ちが}違う。こっちだ」 B 「そっちね」

A: Press this button... wait, no. This one. B: That one, right.

Notes

'A, chigau.' is an immediate expression used when speakers notice that their own understanding, statement, or action is wrong and correct themselves on the spot. 'A' marks the moment of realization, signaling an immediate shift in the speaker's understanding. 'Chigau' then cancels the preceding judgment or intended action without explaining exactly what is wrong. Because the relevant object or action is already shared in the immediate situation, it does not need to be stated explicitly. 'A, chigatta.' is similar, but 'A, chigau.' works especially well as a reaction at the very moment the speaker notices the mistake. It is often followed immediately by a correction such as 'Kocchi da' (This one) or 'Nanoka da' (It's the seventh). In the example, the speaker realizes just before pressing a button that it is the wrong one, says 'A, chigau,' and immediately indicates the correct button.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately correcting oneself upon noticing an error in one's understanding or action

expression revising something just said or about to be done

expression leaving what is wrong unspoken because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

self-correction

revision of understanding

immediate reaction

Oh, it's the other way around.

あ、^{ぎゃく}逆だ。

A, gyaku da.

Oh, it's the other way around.

Variants

- あ、^{ぎゃく}逆だ。

Oh, it's the other way around.

- あ、^{はんたい}反対だ。

Oh, it's backwards.

- ^{ぎゃく}逆、^{ぎゃく}逆。

No, the other way.

- あ、こっちだ。

Oh, this way.

Adjusted Expression

^む向きが^{ぎゃく}逆でした。

It was the other way around.

Example

A 「これをここに^さ差して...あ、^{ぎゃく}逆だ」 B 「^{はんたいむ}反対向きだね」

A: Put this in here... oh, it's the other way around. B: Yeah, turn it around.

Notes

'A, gyaku da.' is an immediate expression used when speakers notice that the direction, orientation, or order of something is reversed and correct themselves on the spot. 'A' marks the moment of realization, signaling an immediate shift in the speaker's understanding. 'Gyaku da' does more than indicate that something is wrong: it identifies the error as a reversal of direction, orientation, or order. What exactly is reversed does not need to be stated because it is apparent from the object or action shared in the immediate situation. Unlike No.849, 'A, chigau,' which generally cancels the speaker's preceding judgment or action upon noticing an error, 'A, gyaku da' immediately identifies the specific type of error as a reversal. In the example, the speaker notices while trying to insert an object that it is facing the wrong way, says 'A, gyaku da,' and immediately corrects its orientation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately correcting oneself upon noticing that the direction or order is reversed

expression identifying the type of error on the spot during an action

expression leaving what is reversed unspoken because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

self-correction

revision of understanding

direction

order

immediate reaction

Acting as if nothing happened.

しれっと

Shiretto.

Acting as if nothing happened.

Variants

- しれっと

Acting as if nothing happened.

- しれっとしてるね

You're acting like nothing happened.

- しれっと^{はい}入ってきたね

You just slipped in like nothing happened.

- しれっと^{すわ}座ってる

You're just sitting there like nothing happened.

Adjusted Expression

まるで何事^{なにごと}もなかったかのように振^ふる舞^まっています。

They are acting as if nothing had happened.

Example

A 「さっきあんなに怒^{おこ}られたのに、しれっと戻^{もど}ってきたね」 B 「ほんとだ」

A: Even after getting scolded like that, they came back as if nothing had happened. B: They really did.

Notes

'Shiretto' is an immediate expression used when the speaker notices someone behaving as though nothing had happened. It does not simply mean 'naturally' or 'casually.' It often carries the nuance that the person is acting with mild cheekiness or audacity, as if the previous incident could simply be ignored. Unlike 'secretly,' which focuses on hiding an action, 'shiretto' describes behaving openly and calmly despite circumstances that would normally make such behavior awkward. What has been glossed over is left unstated because it is understood from the shared situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression commenting immediately on someone acting as if nothing had happened

expression pointing out another person's behavior with a nuance of mild boldness or cheekiness

expression relying on the shared situation to reveal what the speaker believes is being glossed over

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

evaluation

behavior

mild criticism

immediate reaction

That's a relief.

ひとあんしん
これで一安心

Kore de hitoanshin.

That's a relief.

Variants

- ひとあんしん
• これで一安心

That's a relief.

- あんしん
• これで安心

Now that's a relief.

- ひとあんしん
• 一安心だね

That's reassuring.

- あんしん
• これで安心できる。

Now I can relax.

Adjusted Expression

これで心配していたことがひとまず解決しました。

The thing I was worried about has now been resolved for the moment.

Example

A 「荷物、無事に届いたって」 B 「これで一安心」

A: They said the package arrived safely. B: That's a relief.

Notes

'Kore de hitoanshin.' is an immediate expression used when something the speaker has been worried about is resolved or moves into a sufficiently safe state, allowing the speaker to feel relieved. 'Kore de' points to the event that has just occurred and marks it as the reason the speaker can now move from worry to relief. 'Hitoanshin' does not necessarily mean that every problem has been completely solved; rather, it indicates that at least the immediate concern has been settled for the time being. What has been resolved does not need to be stated explicitly because it is understood from the shared situation. In the example, the speaker learns that the package they were worried about has arrived safely and immediately responds, 'Kore de hitoanshin.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression showing relief immediately after a source of worry has been resolved

expression indicating that a concern has, for the moment, been settled by what has just happened

expression using 'kore de' to link the speaker's relief directly to the immediately preceding event

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

relief

resolution of concern

change of state

immediate reaction

Oh, it worked.

あ、いけた

A, iketa.

Oh, it worked.

Variants

- あ、いけた
Oh, it worked.
- お、いけた
Hey, it worked.
- いけた！
It worked!
- よし、いけた
Yes, it worked.

Adjusted Expression

うまくいきました。

It worked.

Example

A 「もう一回、やってみて」 B 「うん...あ、いけた。」 A 「よかった」

A: Try it one more time. B: Okay... oh, it worked. A: Good.

Notes

'A, iketa.' is an immediate expression used when speakers try an operation or method whose success is uncertain and realize at that moment that it has worked. 'A' marks the moment when the speaker notices the successful result. Here, 'ikeru' does not mean being able to go somewhere; it means that something can work, can be done, or is feasible in the situation. For this reason, 'iketa' differs from the more general 'dekita' (I did it / It's done). 'Iketa' is especially natural when the speaker first tries something without knowing whether it will work and then confirms its success from the result. What has worked does not need to be stated because it is evident from the ongoing action or immediately preceding attempt. In the example, the speaker tries an operation again after it previously failed and says 'A, iketa' at the moment they realize that it has now worked.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately indicating success when something being tried turns out to work

expression confirming on the spot that an uncertain operation or method has succeeded

expression leaving what succeeded unspoken because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

success

attempt

confirmation of success

change of state

immediate reaction

Oh, it went through.

あ、^{とお}通った

A, tootta.

Oh, it went through.

Variants

- あ、^{とお}通った

Oh, it went through.

- お、^{とお}通った

Hey, it went through.

- ^{とお}通った！

It went through!

- よし、^{とお}通った

Yes, it went through.

Adjusted Expression

^{せいじょう}正常に^{しょり}処理されました。

It was processed successfully.

Example

A 「もう一回、^{いっかい}パスワード^{ばすわーど}入れてみて」 B 「うん...あ、^{とお}通った」 A 「よかった」

A: Try entering the password one more time. B: Okay... oh, it went through. A: Good.

Notes

'A, tootta.' is an immediate expression used when speakers realize that something requiring acceptance or clearance, such as authentication, a payment, an application, or a communication process, has successfully gone through. 'A' marks the moment when the speaker notices that the process has succeeded. Here, 'tooru' does not refer to a person or object physically passing through a place. Instead, it describes an input, request, or process passing a check or condition and being accepted. What has passed and what it has passed through do not need to be stated because they are evident from the ongoing operation or the result shown on the screen. Unlike No.853, 'A, iketa,' which confirms that an uncertain attempt itself has worked, 'A, tootta' focuses on something having passed a check, condition, or other gate. In the example, the speaker enters the password again and says 'A, tootta' at the moment the screen shows that the authentication has succeeded.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately indicating success when an authentication, transaction, or other process is accepted

expression confirming on the spot that something has passed a check or condition

expression leaving what passed through what unstated because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

success

passing

authentication

confirmation of success

immediate reaction

I finally got it.

やっと^と取れた

Yatto toreta.

I finally got it.

Variants

- やっと^と取れた

I finally got it.

- やっと^と取れたよ

Finally, I got it.

- やっと^と取れた！

I finally got one!

- なんとか^と取れた

I managed to get it.

Adjusted Expression

ようやく^て手^{はい}に入りました。

I finally obtained it.

Example

A 「チケット^{ちけっと}は？」 B 「ああ、やっと^と取れたよ」

A: Did you get the tickets? B: Yeah, I finally got them.

Notes

'Yatto toreta.' is an immediate expression used when speakers finally obtain something that has been difficult to get. 'Yatto' indicates that the success came only after time, effort, or repeated attempts, while 'toreta' marks the moment the desired item has finally been secured. What was obtained does not need to be stated because it is understood from the shared situation. Unlike No.853, 'A, iketa,' which confirms that an uncertain attempt itself has succeeded, 'Yatto toreta.' focuses on finally obtaining the desired object after a prolonged effort. In the example, the speaker is asked about the tickets and replies with relief, 'Yeah, I finally got them.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately indicating success when something difficult to obtain has finally been obtained

expression announcing on the spot that a long effort has finally paid off

expression leaving what was obtained unstated because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

success

achievement

obtaining

relief

immediate reaction

It's finally back.

やっと^{もど}戻った

Yatto modotta.

It's finally back.

Variants

- やっと^{もど}戻った

It's finally back.

- ああ、やっと^{もど}戻った

Yeah, it's finally back.

- ^{もど}戻った

It's back.

- やっと^{もと}元^{もど}に戻った

It's finally back to normal.

Adjusted Expression

^{せいじょう}正常^{じょうたい}な状態^{もど}に戻りました。

It has returned to normal.

Example

A 「^ねネッ^とト、どう？」 B 「ああ、やっと^{もど}戻った」

A: How's the internet? B: Yeah, it's finally back.

Notes

'Yatto modotta' is an immediate expression used when something that had temporarily stopped working or a state that had been lost is finally restored. 'Yatto' indicates that the disruption or problem continued for some time, while 'modotta' marks the return to the previous normal state. What has returned does not need to be stated because it is understood from the shared situation. Unlike expressions such as 'A, iketa' or 'A, tootta,' which confirm that a new attempt or process has succeeded, 'Yatto modotta' focuses on the restoration of a state or function that had once been lost. In the example, the internet connection has been unstable for some time, and when asked about it, the speaker replies, 'Yeah, it's finally back.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately indicating that a temporarily lost state or function has been restored

expression confirming on the spot that a problem or interruption lasting for some time has ended

expression leaving what has returned unstated because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

return

recovery

restoration

change of state

immediate reaction

Well, about that...

それについてはね

Sore ni tsuite wa ne.

Well, about that...

Variants

- それについてはね
Well, about that...
- それについては...
About that...
- そのことについてはね
As for that...
- それなんだけどね
Well, about that...

Adjusted Expression

そのことについてですが、

Regarding that,

Example

A 「あれ、どうした？」 B 「それについてはね、ちょっと^{もんだい}問題があって」 A
「そう」

A: So, what ended up happening with that? B: Well, about that, there's a bit of a problem. A: I see.

Notes

'Sore ni tsuite wa ne' is used when speakers take up a topic just introduced by the listener and prepare to say something about it. 'Sore ni tsuite' explicitly picks up the immediately preceding topic, while 'wa' establishes it as the topic of what follows. The final 'ne' makes the expression conversational, presenting the topic as something shared with the listener while the speaker prepares an explanation. It is especially natural when a simple direct answer is difficult and some background, reservation, or problem needs to be introduced. Once the speaker says 'Sore ni tsuite wa ne,' the listener can anticipate that an explanation is coming. In the example, A asks what happened, and B first takes up the topic with 'Sore ni tsuite wa ne' before continuing with 'there's a bit of a problem.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression taking up a topic introduced by the listener and preparing to explain it

expression delaying a direct answer while signaling that there are circumstances or qualifications to mention

expression using 'sore' to pick up the immediately preceding topic and connect it to what follows

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

topic introduction

topic continuation

preface to explanation

reservation

immediate reaction

Wait, that's the issue?

え、そこなの？

E, soko na no?

Wait, that's the issue?

Variants

- え、そこなの？

Wait, that's the issue?

- え、そこ？

Really, that?

- そこなの？

That's the part?

- そこ^き気になる？

That's what bothers you?

Adjusted Expression

そこが^{もんだい}問題なのですか？

Is that the point you are concerned about?

Example

A 「^{ぶれ ぜん}プレゼン、どうだった？」 B 「うーん、^{かみがた}髪型がちょっとね」 A 「え、そこなの？」

A: How was my presentation? B: Well, your hairstyle was a bit off. A: That's what you're focusing on?

Notes

'E, soko na no?' is an immediate expression used when the listener focuses on a point that the speaker did not expect them to notice or consider important. 'E' marks the speaker's immediate surprise at what has just been said. Here, 'soko' does not necessarily refer to a physical location; it can refer to the particular point, issue, or detail that the listener has just singled out. By asking 'soko na no?' the speaker does more than request confirmation. The expression can convey mild dissatisfaction or surprise, roughly suggesting, 'Of all things, that's what you're focusing on?' Because the speaker questions the listener's focus rather than directly rejecting it, the protest remains relatively soft. In the example, the listener points out a slight misalignment in the text, and the speaker reacts with surprise, 'Wait, that's the issue?'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately showing surprise or mild protest when the listener focuses on an unexpected point

expression questioning the point selected by the listener to show that the speaker finds that focus surprising

expression leaving what 'soko' refers to unstated because it is shared through the immediately preceding utterance or situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

surprise

mild protest

focus

echo question

immediate reaction

Oh, not yet.

あ、まだだった

A, mada datta.

Oh, not yet.

Variants

- あ、まだだった
Oh, not yet.
- あ、まだか
Oh, not yet?
- まだだったか
So, not yet.
- そうか、まだだった
Oh, right, not yet.

Adjusted Expression

まだ済^すんでいませんでした。

It had not been completed yet.

Example

A 「もう送^{おく}った？」 B 「あ、まだだった」

A: Did you send it already? B: Yeah... oh, not yet.

Notes

'A, mada datta.' is an immediate expression used when speakers realize that something they assumed had already been completed has in fact not happened yet. 'A' marks the moment when the speaker notices a fact that conflicts with their previous understanding. 'Mada' indicates that an expected event or state has not been realized up to the present point, while 'datta' reflects the speaker's immediate revision of what they had assumed to be the case. What has not yet been completed does not need to be stated because it is understood from the preceding conversation or the shared situation. In the example, the speaker initially answers as if the email has already been sent, then looks at the screen, realizes that it is still in drafts, and immediately corrects that assumption with 'A, mada datta.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately used when the speaker realizes that something assumed to be finished has not happened yet

expression revising an assumption of completion to non-completion on the spot

expression leaving what has not yet happened unspoken because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

non-completion

revision of understanding

realization

state confirmation

immediate reaction

Of all times, Friday afternoon?

よりによって

Yori ni yotte.

Of all times...

Variants

- よりによって
Of all times...
- よりによって^{きょう}今日？
Today, of all days?
- よりによってそれ？
That, of all things?
- なんでよりによって...
Why, of all things...?

Adjusted Expression

ほかにも^{せんたくし}選択肢があるのに、なぜそれなのでしょう。

Why was that particular option chosen when there were other possibilities?

Example

A「^{かいぎ}会議、^{きんよう}金曜になったって」 B「よりによって^{きんよう}金曜の^{ごご}午後？」

A: They moved the meeting to Friday. B: And Friday afternoon, of all times?

Notes

'Yori ni yotte' is used when speakers react with surprise or dissatisfaction because, out of several possible choices, an especially inconvenient, unexpected, or undesirable one has been selected. It does not simply mean that the chosen time or thing is inconvenient. It also carries the sense that other choices were available, so the speaker wonders why this particular one had to be selected. For this reason, 'yori ni yotte' is commonly followed by a time, person, object, or event that is especially problematic from the speaker's point of view. In the example, the speaker first learns that the meeting has been moved to Friday and then reacts even more strongly on hearing that it will be on Friday afternoon: 'And Friday afternoon, of all times?' The preceding 'sore mo' adds the sense that the second piece of information makes the situation even worse.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression showing surprise or dissatisfaction that an especially inconvenient option was chosen from among many possibilities

expression immediately evaluating the fact that this particular time, thing, or option was selected

expression reacting not simply to the item itself but to the fact that this item was the one chosen

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

dissatisfaction

surprise

selection

immediate evaluation

idiomatic expression

Given the circumstances...

こと こと
事が事だけに

Koto ga koto dake ni.

Given the circumstances...

Variants

- こと こと
事が事だけに

Given the circumstances...

- こと こと
事が事だし

Considering what this is about...

- じじょう じじょう
事情が事情だけに

Given the nature of the situation...

- ないよう ないよう
内容が内容だけに

Considering the nature of the matter...

Adjusted Expression

もんだい せいしつ じゅうだい こうりょ
問題の性質や重大さを考慮すると、

Considering the nature and seriousness of the matter,

Example

A 「どうする、連絡する？」 B 「うん、こと こと
事が事だけに、すべきでしょう」

A: What should we do? Should we contact them? B: Yeah, given the circumstances, I think we should.

Notes

'Koto ga koto dake ni' is used when the nature or seriousness of a matter makes special consideration or action appropriate. The two occurrences of 'koto' refer to the same matter, but repeating the word in 'koto ga koto' signals that the matter is not an ordinary one and has some particular significance that must be taken into account. 'Dake ni' then presents that circumstance as the basis for the judgment or action that follows.

Importantly, the speaker does not state exactly what makes the matter serious or unusual. Because the relevant situation is already shared by the speakers, 'koto ga koto dake ni' can call that shared knowledge back into the conversation and use it as a reason for what follows. In the example, A asks whether they should contact someone. Rather than repeating the details of the problem, B invokes the shared circumstances with 'koto ga koto dake ni' and concludes that they should make contact.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression indicating that a decision should take account of the nature or seriousness of the matter

expression showing that shared circumstances affect the judgment without restating them in detail

expression immediately giving the nature of the matter as a reason for taking special action

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

circumstances

seriousness

judgment

giving a reason

shared information

No, not that.

いや、そこじゃなくて

Iya, soko ja nakute.

No, not that.

Variants

- いや、そこじゃなくて
No, not that.
- そこじゃなくて
Not that.
- いや、そこじゃない
No, not there.
- ^{ちが}違う、そこじゃなくて
No, that's not what I mean.

Adjusted Expression

そこではなく、別の^{べつ}点^{てん}について^い言っています。

I am referring to a different point.

Example

A 「文^{ぶん}を削^{けず}るってこと？」 B 「いや、そこじゃなくて、見^み出^だしのほう」

A: You mean I should cut down the text? B: No, not that. I mean the heading.

Notes

'Iya, soko ja nakute' is an immediate expression used when speakers notice that the listener has focused on a point different from what they intended and redirect that focus on the spot. 'Iya' signals an immediate correction of the listener's preceding interpretation, while 'soko ja nakute' indicates that the problem lies specifically in the point being focused on rather than in the listener's entire understanding. Here, 'soko' does not necessarily refer to a physical location; it can refer to a point or part of the immediately preceding discussion. Ending with 'nakute' also leaves the utterance open and signals that the intended point or a further explanation will follow. What 'soko' refers to does not need to be stated explicitly because it is understood from the preceding utterance or shared situation. In the example, A assumes that the suggestion concerns shortening the text, and B immediately redirects the focus with 'Iya, soko ja nakute' before specifying that the heading is the intended point.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately redirecting the focus when the listener has focused on a point different from what the speaker intended

expression correcting only the point that is off rather than rejecting the listener's entire understanding

expression leaving what 'soko' refers to unstated because it is shared through the immediately preceding utterance or situation

expression signaling that the intended point or an explanation will follow

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

focus correction

revision of understanding

response

discourse

immediate reaction

Oh, that explains it.

あ、それでか

A, sore de ka.

Oh, that explains it.

Variants

- あ、それでか
Oh, that explains it.
- それでか
That explains it.
- ああ、それでか
Ah, that explains it.
- なるほど、それでか
I see, that explains it.

Adjusted Expression

それが^{りゆう}理由だったのですね。

So that was the reason.

Example

A 「あ、^{しま}閉ってる」 B 「^{きょう}今日、^{しゅくじつ}祝日だからね」 A 「あ、それでか」

A: Oh, it's closed. B: Yeah, because it's a holiday today. A: Oh, that explains it.

Notes

'A, sore de ka' is an immediate expression used when newly received information suddenly explains something that had previously seemed puzzling or unexplained. 'A' marks the moment when the speaker reaches a new understanding. 'Sore de' takes the listener's immediately preceding statement as the cause or reason, while 'ka' marks the speaker's realization and acceptance of that causal connection. What has now been explained does not need to be stated because it is understood from the preceding conversation or shared situation. Unlike an expression such as 'Aa, sou iu koto ka,' which indicates understanding of an explanation more generally, 'A, sore de ka' specifically focuses on recognizing the causal connection between the newly given information and something that had previously been puzzling. In the example, the speaker learns that it is a holiday and immediately realizes that this explains why the situation is different from usual.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately showing understanding when newly received information explains something that had previously seemed puzzling

expression taking the listener's preceding information as the cause and recognizing the causal connection on the spot

expression leaving what has now been explained unstated because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

realization

understanding a reason

causal relation

revision of understanding

immediate reaction

Do we really need to go that far?

ひつよう
そこまで必要？

Soko made hitsuyou?

Do we really need to go that far?

Variants

- ひつよう
そこまで必要？

Do we really need to go that far?

- ひつよう
え、そこまで必要？

Do we really need all that?

- ひつよう
そこまでの必要ある？

Do we need to go that far?

- そこまでやる？

Are we really going that far?

Adjusted Expression

たいおう ひつよう
そこまで対応する必要がありますか？

Is it necessary to go that far?

Example

A 「資料は紙でも用意して、USB にも入れて、念のためクラウドにも二か所置いておこう」 B 「ひつよう
そこまで必要？」

A: Let's print the materials, put them on a USB drive, and, just in case, keep copies in two places in the cloud too. B: Do we really need to go that far?

Notes

'Soko made hitsuyou?' is an immediate expression used when speakers hear a proposed preparation or response and question whether it is really necessary to go to that extent. 'Soko' does not refer to a physical location here; it points to the degree of action or preparation just described. 'Made' presents that degree as an endpoint, and 'hitsuyou?' questions whether reaching that endpoint is necessary. Unlike simply asking 'Hitsuyou?' (Is it necessary?), the expression can imply that the speaker considers the proposed action somewhat excessive. The exact action and degree do not need to be repeated because they are already available from the preceding utterance. In the example, A proposes preparing paper copies, a USB copy, and copies in two cloud locations. B responds with 'Soko made hitsuyou?' to question whether that much preparation is really necessary.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately questioning whether the degree of preparation or action proposed by the listener is really necessary

expression suggesting that an action or response may go further than necessary

expression leaving the action and its extent unstated because they are shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

necessity

degree

questioning

excess

immediate evaluation

Quite apart from that, ...

～もさることながら

... *mo saru koto nagara*.

Quite apart from that, ...

Variants

- ～もさることながら

Quite apart from that, ...

- それもさることながら

That is important too, but ...

- ^{ないよう}内容もさることながら、...

The content is important, but ...

- ^{けっか}結果もさることながら、...

The result is important, but ...

Adjusted Expression

^{まえ}前に^あ挙げた^{てん}点も^{じゅうよう}重要ですが、それに^{くわ}加えて^{べつ}別の^{てん}点も^{じゅうよう}重要です。

The point already mentioned is important, but another point is also important.

Example

A ^{えつらんすう}「閲覧数、かなり^ふ増えたね」 B 「うん、^{えつらんすう}閲覧数もさることながら、^{だうんろーどすう}ダウンロード数も^ふ増えてる」

A: The number of views has increased quite a bit. B: Yes, the increase in views is notable, but so is the rise in downloads.

Notes

'... mo saru koto nagara' is used when speakers acknowledge the importance or relevance of a point already under discussion and then extend attention to another point. Here, 'saru koto' has the sense of 'that being so' or 'that being important,' and the full expression functions roughly as 'that is important too, but not only that.' It does not reject or downplay the preceding point. Instead, it preserves that evaluation while adding another dimension for consideration. The expression can be used in speech, but it is somewhat more formal than alternatives such as '... mo mochiron sou da ga.' In the example, the speaker acknowledges the increase in views and then adds that the rise in downloads is also noteworthy.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression acknowledging a point already under consideration while extending the evaluation to another point

expression introducing an additional matter without denying the importance of the preceding one

expression adding another dimension of evaluation and directing attention to what follows

somewhat formal expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

evaluation

additional evaluation

topic development

comparison

connective expression

somewhat formal

Wait, I wasn't told that.

それは^き聞いてない

Sore wa kiitenai.

Wait, I wasn't told that.

Variants

- それは^き聞いてない
Wait, I wasn't told that.
- え、それは^き聞いてない
Wait, I didn't hear about that.
- それ、^き聞いてない
Nobody told me that.
- そんなの^き聞いてない
I wasn't told anything about that.

Adjusted Expression

そのことは^{じぜん}事前に^き聞いていませんでした。

I had not been informed of that beforehand.

Example

A 「明日の^{あした}打ち^う合わせ、^あ9時^じからね。資料^{しりょう}も一人^{ひとり}10分^{ぶん}ずつ^{せつめい}説明^{せつめい}してもらうから」 B 「え、それは^き聞いてない」

A: Tomorrow's meeting starts at nine, and everyone will have ten minutes to explain their materials. B: Wait, I wasn't told that.

Notes

'Sore wa kiitenai.' is an immediate expression used when speakers react to newly presented information by indicating that they had not previously been told about it. Here, 'kiitenai' does not simply mean that the speaker failed to hear something acoustically. It means that the information had not been communicated to them beforehand as something they needed to know. 'Sore wa' picks up the information in the listener's immediately preceding utterance and marks it as significant because it affects the speaker's assumptions, plans, or expectations. For this reason, 'Sore wa kiitenai' can carry mild protest in addition to reporting a lack of information, suggesting something like, 'You should have told me that earlier.' What the speaker had not been told does not need to be repeated because it is clear from the preceding utterance. In the example, B learns for the first time that each person must give a ten-minute explanation at the meeting and immediately responds, 'Wait, I wasn't told that.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately reacting to important information that the speaker had not previously been told

expression showing mild protest when information that changes the speaker's assumptions is introduced only afterward

expression leaving what the speaker had not been told unstated because it is available from the immediately preceding utterance

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

new information

mild protest

change of assumptions

lack of information

immediate reaction

I just realized that as I was saying it.

いま い おも
今、言ッててそう思ッた

Ima, ittete sou omotta.

I just realized that as I was saying it.

Variants

- いま い おも
● 今、言ッててそう思ッた

I just realized that as I was saying it.

- いま い おも
● 今、言いながらそう思ッた

I realized that while I was saying it.

- いま い き
● 今、言ッてて気づいた

I just noticed that as I was saying it.

- い おも
● 言ッてて思ッたんだけど

I was just thinking that as I said it.

Adjusted Expression

いま はな おも
今、話しているうちに、そのように思いました。

I came to think that while I was speaking.

Example

A 「この仕事、結局ずっと自分で抱えてるんだよね...あ、いま い おも
今、言ッててそう思ッた」 B 「たしかに」

A: I've basically been handling this work all by myself the whole time...
oh, I just realized that as I was saying it. B: That's true.

Notes

'Ima, ittete sou omotta' is an immediate expression used when speakers arrive at a new realization while they are talking, with their own utterance serving as the trigger for that realization. 'Ima' marks the fact that the realization has occurred at that very moment, while 'ittete,' a colloquial form of 'itte ite,' indicates that it arose during the ongoing act of speaking. 'Sou' refers back to the content of the speaker's own immediately preceding utterance, and 'omotta' marks the emergence of a new thought or understanding about that content. While we often assume that speakers first form a thought and then put it into words, this expression captures the reverse process: speaking itself leads to realization. What the speaker has come to think does not need to be repeated because it is recoverable from the immediately preceding utterance. In the example, the speaker talks about having carried the work alone and, in the course of saying it, realizes this more clearly and comments on that realization immediately.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression indicating that a new realization arose while the speaker was talking, triggered by their own utterance

expression conveying on the spot that the thought was not fully formed beforehand but emerged during speaking

expression using 'sou' to refer back to the speaker's own immediately preceding utterance

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

self-realization

realization during speech

formation of understanding

self-reference

immediate reaction

Where do we start?

どこから^て手をつける？

Doko kara te o tsukeru?

Where do we start?

Variants

- どこから^て手をつける？

Where do we start?

- ^{なに}何から^て手をつける？

What do we start with?

- まず、どこから？

Where do we begin?

- どこからやる？

What should we tackle first?

Adjusted Expression

まず、どの^{さぎょう}作業から^{はじ}始めますか？

Which task should we begin with first?

Example

A 「^{しゅうせい}修正するところ、かなり^{おお}多いね」 B 「うん、どこから^て手をつける？」

A: There are quite a lot of things to fix. B: Yeah. Where do we start?

Notes

'Doko kara te o tsukeru?' is used when there are several tasks or problems to deal with and the speakers need to decide on the spot what to begin with. Here, 'te o tsukeru' does not literally mean to put one's hand on something; it is an idiomatic expression meaning to start working on a task, issue, or problem. 'Doko kara' likewise does not ask about a physical location. It asks which part of the shared set of tasks should be chosen as the first point of action. Because the relevant work or problem is already understood from the preceding conversation or immediate situation, the speaker does not need to restate it. In the example, after confirming that there are many things to revise, B asks 'Doko kara te o tsukeru?' in order to decide what to tackle first.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used to decide on the spot what to begin with when there are several things to do

expression for choosing the first point of action in a task or problem-solving process

expression selecting a first step from a shared set of tasks without restating the whole situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

getting started

task initiation

prioritization

problem solving

consultation

Oh, right!

あ、そうそう

A, sou sou.

Oh, right!

Variants

- あ、そうそう
Oh, right!
- そうそう
Right, right.
- ああ、そうそう
Oh yeah, that's right.
- そうだ、そうだ
Oh, that's right.

Adjusted Expression

ああ、そうでした。それについて^{おも}思い出^だしました。

Oh, that's right. I just remembered something about that.

Example

A 「明日^{あした}の会議^{かいぎ}、資料^{しりょう}も持^もってきてね」 B 「あ、そうそう。それ、聞^きこうと思^{おも}ってた」

A: Bring the materials to tomorrow's meeting too. B: Oh, right! I was going to ask you about that.

Notes

'A, sou sou.' is an immediate expression used when something the listener says or something in the situation suddenly triggers a related memory. 'A' marks the moment of recollection, while 'sou sou' takes up the preceding topic and signals that the speaker has just remembered something connected with it. Unlike 'sou sou' used simply to show agreement, 'A, sou sou' often introduces something the speaker had forgotten to mention or had been meaning to bring up. It therefore works as a conversational device for retrieving a related topic and moving directly into the next utterance. In the example, while talking about the next day's meeting, B suddenly remembers something they had intended to ask and says 'A, sou sou' before bringing it up.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately used when something the listener says or something in the situation triggers a related memory

expression bringing something just remembered back into the conversation on the spot

expression taking up the preceding topic while shifting to something related

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

recollection

memory retrieval

topic retrieval

topic shift

immediate reaction

You'll understand in time.

そのうち、わかる

Sono uchi, wakaru.

You'll understand in time.

Variants

- そのうち、わかる
You'll understand in time.
- そのうち、わかるよ
You'll get it eventually.
- ^{いま}今はわからなくても、そのうち、わかる
Even if you don't understand now, you will in time.
- まあ、そのうち、わかる
Well, you'll understand eventually.

Adjusted Expression

^{いま}今は^{りかい}理解できなくとも、^{じかん}時間がたてば^{りかい}理解できるようになります。

Even if you do not understand it now, you will understand it with time.

Example

A 「どうして？」 B 「まあ、^{いそ}急ぐな。そのうち、わかる」

A: Why? B: Don't rush. You'll understand in time.

Notes

'Sono uchi, wakaru' is used when speakers tell someone that something they do not understand now will become clear with time. 'Sono uchi' does not specify an exact future point; instead, it leaves the timing open and suggests that the situation or the listener's understanding will change as time passes. 'Wakaru' indicates that the listener will eventually come to understand, rather than that the speaker will necessarily explain everything immediately. For this reason, the expression can both respond to a question and temporarily withhold further explanation, leaving understanding to the future. Depending on tone, it can sound reassuring, patient, or slightly suggestive of something that will become clear later. In the example, when asked 'Why?', the speaker does not give a full explanation but says, 'You'll understand in time.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression telling the listener that something not understood now will become understandable with time

expression postponing full explanation and leaving understanding to a future point

expression softening the listener's uncertainty or impatience while temporarily withholding further explanation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

withholding explanation

future understanding

prediction

reassurance

time

immediate reaction

We can't afford to sit around.

うかうかしてられない

Ukauka shiterarenai.

We can't afford to sit around.

Variants

- うかうかしてられない

We can't afford to sit around.

- うかうかしてられない

We can't waste any time.

- のんびりしてられない

We can't just take it easy.

- ^{いそ}急がないと

We'd better hurry.

Adjusted Expression

のんびりしている^{じかん}時間はありません。

There is no time to remain idle.

Example

A ^{しめきり}「締切、^{こんしゅう}今週の^{きんよう}金曜だって」 B「え、もうそんなに^{ちか}近いの？ うかうかしてられないね」

A: The deadline is this Friday. B: What, it's that soon? We can't afford to sit around.

Notes

'Ukauka shiterarenai.' is an immediate expression used when speakers realize that a deadline is approaching or that a situation has become urgent and conclude that they can no longer remain relaxed or inactive. 'Ukauka suru' describes spending time inattentively, carelessly, or without taking necessary action. 'Shiterarenai' is the colloquial form of 'shite irarenai' and indicates that the speaker can no longer afford to remain in that state. The expression therefore does more than warn against carelessness; it marks a shift from recognizing the situation to deciding that action must begin. What needs to be done does not have to be stated because it is already understood from the preceding conversation or shared situation. In the example, B learns that the deadline is much closer than expected and immediately responds, 'Ukauka shiterarenai ne,' indicating that there is no longer time to sit around.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately indicating that there is no longer time to remain idle or relaxed when the situation becomes urgent

expression responding to a newly recognized deadline or situation by judging that action must be taken quickly

expression leaving what needs to be done unstated because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

urgency

taking action

time constraint

situational judgment

immediate reaction

Yeah, that makes sense.

まあ、そうなるよね

Maa, sou naru yo ne.

Yeah, that makes sense.

Variants

- まあ、そうなるよね
Yeah, that makes sense.
- そうなるよね
That makes sense.
- やっぱり、そうなるよね
Yeah, that's what you'd expect.
- そりゃ、そうなるよね
Well, of course that's what happens.

Adjusted Expression

そのような^{けっか}結果になるのは^{しぜん}自然だ^{おも}と思います。

I think that is a natural outcome.

Example

A 「やっぱり、^{きょう}今日は^{ちゅうし}中止だって」 B 「まあ、そうなるよね」

A: They said it's canceled today after all. B: Yeah, that makes sense.

Notes

'Maa, sou naru yo ne' is an immediate expression used when speakers receive a result and evaluate it as a natural or predictable outcome. 'Maa' signals a relatively calm acceptance rather than strong surprise, while 'sou' refers to the situation or result just mentioned. 'Naru' presents that result as something reached through the course of events, and 'yo ne' presents the evaluation as something the listener can also recognize or share. The expression therefore does more than acknowledge what happened; it conveys the sense that, given the circumstances, this is the kind of result one would expect. The variant 'yappari, sou naru yo ne' emphasizes that the outcome matches an earlier expectation, while 'sorya, sou naru yo ne' places more emphasis on the outcome being unsurprising or inevitable. In the example, the speaker hears that an event has been canceled and immediately accepts that result as understandable under the circumstances.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately evaluating a reported result as a predictable outcome

expression accepting the result as a natural or understandable consequence rather than reacting with surprise

expression using 'sou' to refer to the immediately preceding result or situation and treating it as an expected consequence

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

evaluation of outcome

expectation

acceptance

predictability

immediate reaction

It's just a small thing, but...

ちょっとしたことだけど

Chotto shita koto da kedo.

It's just a small thing, but...

Variants

- ちょっとしたことだけど
It's just a small thing, but...
- ちょっとしたことなんだけど
It's just a minor thing, but...
- ^{たい}大したことじゃないんだけど
It's nothing major, but...
- ^{こま}細かいことだけど
It's a small detail, but...

Adjusted Expression

^{おお}大きな^{もんだい}問題ではありませんが、^{すこ}少し^き気になることがあります。

It is not a major issue, but there is something small that concerns me.

Example

A 「どうしたの？」 B 「ちょっとしたことだけど、ここが^{すこ}少し^き気になって」

A: What's wrong? B: It's just a small thing, but this part bothered me a little.

Notes

'Chotto shita koto da kedo' is used when speakers present what they are about to say as a relatively minor matter rather than a serious problem. 'Chotto shita' does not simply indicate a small degree; it evaluates something as minor, trivial, or not especially serious. Ending with 'da kedo' leaves the utterance open and signals that a specific comment or observation will follow. By using this expression first, speakers lower the perceived weight of what comes next and help prevent the listener from taking the comment too seriously. It is especially useful before making a small criticism, observation, or complaint, where it serves to soften the force of the following utterance. In the example, the speaker says 'It's just a small thing, but...' before mentioning a detail that bothered them, signaling that the issue is not a major one.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression presenting what follows as a relatively minor matter rather than a major problem

expression softening a comment or criticism before stating it

expression adjusting how the listener is expected to receive the following utterance

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

preface

softening

evaluation adjustment

comment

preface to utterance

That makes things easier.

それなら、^{はなし}話は^{はや}早い

Sore nara, hanashi wa hayai.

That makes things easier.

Variants

- それなら、^{はなし}話は^{はや}早い

That makes things easier.

- じゃあ、^{はなし}話は^{はや}早い

Well, that simplifies things.

- だったら、^{はなし}話は^{はや}早い

If that's the case, this will be easy.

- それなら、^{はなし}話が^{はや}早い

That makes this much simpler.

Adjusted Expression

それでしたら、^{せつめい}説明や^{そうだん}相談を^{かんたん}簡単に^{すす}進めることができます。

If that is the case, we can proceed with the discussion more easily.

Example

A 「^{たなか}田中さんも、このこと知^しってるよ」 B 「あ、それなら、^{はなし}話は^{はや}早い」

A: Tanaka already knows about this too. B: Oh, that makes things easier.

Notes

'Sore nara, hanashi wa hayai' is used when newly received information makes speakers realize that an explanation, discussion, negotiation, or other interaction can now proceed more easily than expected. 'Sore nara' takes the listener's immediately preceding statement as a condition, with the sense of 'if that is the case.' 'Hanashi wa hayai' does not literally mean that the conversation itself is fast. Rather, it indicates that some intermediate explanation, discussion, or procedure can be shortened or skipped, allowing matters to move forward more directly. The expression therefore involves an immediate shift from receiving information to evaluating its practical consequence for what happens next. In the example, the speaker had assumed that Tanaka would need to be informed from the beginning, but on learning that Tanaka already knows about the matter, immediately responds, 'Oh, that makes things easier.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when newly received information immediately makes the speaker realize that the following explanation or discussion can proceed more easily

expression taking the listener's preceding statement as a condition and judging that, if it holds, matters can move forward quickly

expression indicating on the spot that some explanation, discussion, or procedure previously thought necessary can now be shortened or skipped

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

condition

situational judgment

shortening explanation

progress

immediate reaction

If you insist.

そこまで言うなら

Soko made iu nara.

If you insist.

Variants

- そこまで言うなら
If you insist.
- そこまで言うならね
Well, if you insist.
- そこまで言うんだったら
If you feel that strongly about it.
- そこまで言うなら、やってみる
If you insist, I'll give it a try.

Adjusted Expression

そこまで強くおっしゃるのであれば、考えを変えます。

If you feel that strongly about it, I will reconsider.

Example

A 「ほんとにいいから、一度だけ見えてみてよ」 B 「そこまで言うなら、見てみるよ」

A: It's really good, so just give it a try. B: If you insist, I'll check it out.

Notes

'Soko made iu nara' is used when speakers respond to strong encouragement or insistence by treating the strength of the listener's words as a reason to change their own decision or action. 'Soko made' does not refer to physical distance here; it refers to how strongly or persistently the listener has expressed a recommendation or opinion. 'Nara' turns that degree of insistence into a condition, roughly meaning 'if you feel that strongly about it.' The expression therefore does not protest against what the listener has said. Instead, it acknowledges the listener's insistence and marks a shift from reluctance toward acceptance or action. Unlike No.236, 'Soko made iu?', which reacts to someone's words as going too far and expresses mild protest or hurt, 'Soko made iu nara' uses the strength of those words as a condition for the speaker's next decision. In the example, the speaker changes from reluctance to willingness after being strongly encouraged and says, 'If you insist, I'll check it out.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression treating the strength of the listener's recommendation or insistence as a condition for changing the speaker's decision

expression immediately shifting from reluctance to acceptance because of the listener's strong encouragement

expression using 'soko made' to refer to the strength of the preceding insistence and 'nara' to turn it into a condition

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

condition

concession

acceptance

change of decision

insistence

immediate reaction

While we still can.

いま
今のうちに

Ima no uchi ni.

While we still can.

Variants

- いま
今のうちに

While we still can.

- いま
今のうちにやっておこう

Let's do it while we still can.

- だいじょうぶ
まだ大丈夫なうちに

While we still have the chance.

- できるうちに

While it's still possible.

Adjusted Expression

じょうきょう か まえ いま
状 況が変わる前に、今できることをしておきましょう。

Let's do what we can now before the situation changes.

Example

A 「ゆうがた あめ
夕方から雨だって」 B 「じゃ、いま か もの い
今のうちに買い物行ってこよう」

A: They say it's going to rain this evening. B: Then I'll go shopping now, while I still can.

Notes

'Ima no uchi ni' is used when speakers recognize that something is still possible or convenient at the present moment but may soon become difficult, and decide to act before that change occurs. 'Ima' here does more than identify the present time; it points to a currently available opportunity or favorable condition. 'Uchi ni' indicates acting within the period during which that condition still holds. The expression therefore implicitly contains an expected future change: something can be done now, but it may no longer be possible later. The speaker does not need to state explicitly what will change because it is understood from the preceding conversation or immediate situation. In the example, B hears that it will rain in the evening, treats the current dry period as a temporary opportunity, and immediately decides to go shopping 'ima no uchi ni' before the weather changes.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression indicating an immediate decision to act before favorable current conditions disappear

expression prompting action on the understanding that something is possible now but may become difficult later

expression making use of the present opportunity without explicitly stating the expected future change

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

opportunity

time constraint

situational judgment

taking action

acting in advance

Oh, I see. That makes sense.

ああ、そういうことね

Aa, sou iu koto ne.

Oh, I see. That makes sense.

Variants

- ああ、そういうことね
Oh, I see. That makes sense.
- あ、そういうことね
Oh, I see.
- なるほど、そういうことね
I see, that makes sense.
- ああ、そういうことね、わかった
Oh, I see. Got it.

Adjusted Expression

そのような事情^{じじょう}だったのですね。それなら理解^{りかい}できます。

So that was the situation. That makes sense.

Example

A「あの^{ひと}人、昨日^{きのう}急に^{いきゅう}帰^{かえ}っちゃったんだよ」 B「え、なんで？」 A「子^こどもが
熱^{ねつ}出した^だって連絡^{れんらく}があったんだって」 B「ああ、そういうことね」

A: They suddenly went home yesterday. B: Why? A: Apparently they got a call saying their child had a fever. B: Oh, I see. That makes sense.

Notes

'Aa, sou iu koto ne' is used when speakers hear an explanation for something that initially seemed puzzling and immediately accept the event as understandable in light of those circumstances. 'Aa' marks the moment when the speaker's understanding shifts as a result of the explanation. 'Sou iu koto' packages the preceding explanation or circumstances as a single understandable account, while the final particle 'ne' presents that understanding as something shared with the listener and accepted conversationally. This differs from No.108, 'Aa, sou iu koto ka!', which places stronger emphasis on discovery and realization when a puzzle or question is resolved. 'Aa, sou iu koto ne' instead emphasizes accepting and normalizing an unexpected event once its circumstances become clear. Although the difference between final 'ka' and 'ne' is formally small, their discourse functions are markedly different: 'ka' foregrounds realization, while 'ne' foregrounds shared understanding and acceptance. In the example, the person's sudden departure initially seems puzzling, but once the speaker hears that the person's child had a fever, the event becomes understandable and the speaker responds, 'Oh, I see. That makes sense.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when an initially puzzling event becomes understandable after an explanation is given

expression immediately reevaluating an unexpected event as reasonable or unsurprising in light of new information

expression using 'sou iu koto' to summarize the preceding explanation and 'ne' to share the resulting understanding and acceptance with the listener

colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- understanding
- acceptance
- reevaluation
- understanding circumstances
- sentence-final particle
- immediate reaction

I don't have time for that now.

それどころじゃない

Sore dokoro ja nai.

I don't have time for that now.

Variants

- それどころじゃない

I don't have time for that now.

- ^{いま}今はそれどころじゃない

That's the least of my concerns right now.

- それどころじゃなくなった

I've got bigger things to worry about.

- そんな^{ばあい}場合じゃない

This is no time for that.

Adjusted Expression

^{いま}今は、もっと^{ゆうせん}優先して^{たいおう}対応すべきことがあります。

There is something more urgent that needs to be dealt with now.

Example

A「^{きょう}今日、^{かえ}帰りに^{えいが}映画行く？」 B「^{れぽーと}レポート、^{あした}明日までだった。それどころじゃない」

A: Want to go see a movie on the way home today? B: My report's due tomorrow. I don't have time for that now.

Notes

'Sore dokoro ja nai' is used when speakers realize that a more urgent problem or priority leaves no room to deal with the matter that has just been mentioned. 'Sore' picks up the preceding suggestion or topic, while 'dokoro ja nai' indicates that the speaker is not in a situation where they can reasonably think about or engage in it. The expression therefore does more than simply reject a suggestion. It marks an immediate change in priorities caused by another circumstance, pushing the preceding topic out of the speaker's current range of action. What now takes priority does not always need to be stated explicitly because it is often clear from the preceding conversation or immediate situation. In the example, B is invited to go see a movie but suddenly remembers that a report is due the next day and immediately responds, 'Sore dokoro ja nai,' shifting attention to the more urgent task.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression indicating that a more urgent problem leaves no room to deal with the matter just mentioned

expression showing an immediate shift in priorities because of newly recognized circumstances

expression setting aside the preceding topic without explicitly stating what now takes priority

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

priority

urgency

setting aside a topic

change of situation

immediate judgment

Oh, that makes sense.

あ、それならわかる

A, sore nara wakaru.

Oh, that makes sense.

Variants

- あ、それならわかる
Oh, that makes sense.
- ああ、それならわかる
Ah, that makes sense.
- それならわかるよ
Then I can understand.
- それなら^{なっとく}納得
That makes sense.

Adjusted Expression

そのような^{じじょう}事情であれば、その^{こうどう}行動は^{りかい}理解できます。

Under those circumstances, the action is understandable.

Example

A「^{たなか}田中さん、^{きょう}今日の^{かいぎ}会議、^こ来ないんだって」 B「え、なんで？」 A「^{きのう}昨日から^{ねつ}熱があるらしいよ」 B「あ、それならわかる」

A: Apparently Tanaka isn't coming to today's meeting. B: Why not? A: I heard he's had a fever since yesterday. B: Oh, that makes sense.

Notes

'A, sore nara wakaru' is used when speakers receive new information about an action or event that initially seemed difficult to understand and immediately reevaluate it as understandable under the newly stated circumstances. 'A' marks the moment when the speaker's understanding shifts in response to the new information. 'Sore nara' takes the circumstances just mentioned and turns them into a condition, roughly meaning 'if that is the case' or 'under those circumstances.' 'Wakaru' here does not simply mean that the speaker understands the words or explanation. Rather, it indicates that the action or decision in question now makes sense given the stated condition. The expression therefore captures a change from an initial evaluation of something as puzzling to a new evaluation of it as understandable. Unlike No.877, 'Aa, sou iu koto ne,' which focuses on understanding the circumstances as a whole and accepting an initially puzzling event as natural, 'A, sore nara wakaru' explicitly turns the newly received information into a condition with 'sore nara' and reevaluates the action or decision as understandable under that condition. In the example, Tanaka's absence initially seems puzzling, but after hearing that he has had a fever, the speaker changes their evaluation and responds, 'Oh, that makes sense.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately reevaluating a previously puzzling action or event as understandable after receiving new information

expression taking the circumstances just mentioned as a condition and indicating that the action or decision makes sense under that condition

expression showing that new information has made something previously difficult to understand understandable

colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- understanding
- condition
- reevaluation
- understanding circumstances
- change of evaluation
- immediate reaction

I can't really afford to say that.

そうも^い言^いってられない

Sou mo itterarenai.

I can't really afford to say that.

Variants

- そうも^い言^いってられない
I can't really afford to say that.
- そうも^い言^いってられない
I can't keep saying that.
- そんなこと^い言^いってられない
I can't really take that position now.
- そうしたいんだけどね
I'd like to, but I can't.

Adjusted Expression

そうしたいところですが、^{じょうきょう}状^{かんが}況^{かんが}を考えると、そのままではられません。

I would prefer to do that, but the circumstances do not allow me to maintain that position.

Example

A「^{きょう}今日^{やす}はもう休^{やす}んだら？」 B「^{あした}そうしたいけど、^{しめきり}明日^{しめきり}が締切だから、^いそうも^い言^いってられないんだよね」

A: Why don't you call it a day? B: I'd like to, but the deadline is tomorrow, so I can't really afford to say that.

Notes

'Sou mo itterarenai' is used when speakers would prefer to accept or maintain a preceding idea or course of action but immediately judge that circumstances no longer allow them to do so. 'Sou' takes up the preceding statement or idea as a whole. 'Itterarenai' is the colloquial form of 'itte irarenai,' but 'iu' here does not simply refer to the physical act of speaking. It indicates that the speaker cannot afford to continue holding or expressing that position under the present circumstances. The expression therefore preserves the sense that the speaker would ideally like to follow the preceding suggestion while also marking a necessary shift toward a different action or judgment. In the example, B agrees in principle that resting would be preferable, but because the deadline is the next day, B concludes that this is no longer a position they can realistically maintain.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression indicating that the speaker would prefer to maintain a certain view or course of action but circumstances no longer allow it

expression taking up a preceding statement or idea with 'sou' and immediately judging that it cannot be maintained

expression showing that newly recognized conditions or urgent circumstances require a change of course

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

change of course

situational judgment

urgency

reservation

immediate reaction

Oh, then that's fine.

あ、それならいいんだけど

A, sore nara ii n da kedo.

Oh, then that's fine.

Variants

- あ、それならいいんだけど
Oh, then that's fine.
- それならいいんだけど
Then that's fine.
- ああ、それならいいんだけど
Ah, okay, then that's fine.
- まあ、それならいいんだけど
Well, if that's the case, that's fine.

Adjusted Expression

そのような事情^{じじょう}であれば、問題^{もんだい}ありません。

If that is the case, there is no problem.

Example

A「明日^{あした}の資料^{しりょう}、まだ送^{おく}ってないの？」 B「うん。でも、明日^{あした}の朝^{あさ}でいいって言^いわれてるから」 A「あ、それならいいんだけど」

A: You haven't sent tomorrow's materials yet? B: No, but they told me tomorrow morning is fine. A: Oh, then that's fine.

Notes

'A, sore nara ii n da kedo' is an immediate expression used when speakers receive an explanation about something they had been concerned about and reevaluate the situation as acceptable under the newly stated circumstances. 'A' marks the moment when the speaker's understanding shifts in response to the new information. 'Sore nara' takes the circumstances just mentioned and turns them into a condition, roughly meaning 'if that is the case.' 'Ii' evaluates the situation as acceptable under that condition. The final 'n da kedo' is especially important. Although 'kedo' normally introduces a contrasting continuation, the speaker can end the utterance without stating what would follow. This makes the expression less categorical than simply saying 'sore nara ii' and leaves a slight sense of reservation or lingering concern. Unlike 'sou dekireba ii n da kedo,' which expresses a wish while leaving uncertainty about whether it can be realized, 'A, sore nara ii n da kedo' responds to information already received and temporarily resolves a present concern. In the example, the speaker is worried that the materials have not yet been sent, but after hearing that sending them the next morning is acceptable, responds, 'Oh, then that's fine.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately reevaluating a previously concerning situation as acceptable after hearing an explanation

expression taking the circumstances just mentioned as a condition and temporarily resolving the speaker's concern

expression accepting the situation as fine while leaving a slight nuance of reservation or unfinished concern with 'kedo'

colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- relief
- acceptance
- condition
- reevaluation
- reservation
- unfinished utterance
- immediate reaction

Oh, that's what you mean.

あ、そういう意味ね

A, sou iu imi ne.

Oh, that's what you mean.

Variants

- あ、そういう意味ね
Oh, that's what you mean.
- ああ、そういう意味ね
Ah, that's what you mean.
- そういう意味ね
That's what you mean.

Adjusted Expression

ああ、そういう意味だったのですね。

Oh, I see. That is what you meant.

Example

A 「今日は早く帰ったほうがいいよ」 B 「え、仕事まだあるけど」 A 「いや、電車、止まりそうだから」 B 「あ、そういう意味ね」

A: You should go home early today. B: But I still have work to do. A: No, I mean the trains might stop running. B: Oh, that's what you mean.

Notes

'A, sou iu imi ne' is used when speakers initially interpret another person's utterance in one way but revise that interpretation immediately after receiving clarification. 'A' marks the moment when the interpretation changes in response to new information. 'Sou iu imi' refers specifically to the meaning the other person intended in the preceding utterance, while 'ne' presents the newly reached understanding as something now shared between the speakers. The expression therefore makes visible a temporal sequence: hearing an utterance, forming an interpretation, receiving clarification, and revising that interpretation. The existing expression 'sou iu imi de wa nain desu kedo ne' is used from the opposite side of the interaction: the speaker rejects another person's interpretation of what they meant and corrects a misunderstanding. 'Sou iu imi de, ...' instead takes the preceding content as a perspective and connects it to a following evaluation or conclusion. By contrast, 'A, sou iu imi ne' marks the speaker's own immediate reinterpretation of another person's intended meaning. It also differs from No.877, 'Aa, sou iu koto ne,' which focuses more broadly on understanding circumstances or what has happened; 'A, sou iu imi ne' focuses specifically on revising the interpretation of another person's utterance.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when the speaker initially interpreted someone's utterance differently and immediately revises that interpretation after receiving clarification

expression showing that new information has made the speaker understand what the other person meant

expression marking an immediate shift from misunderstanding to understanding

colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- meaning
- interpretation
- reinterpretation
- misunderstanding
- understanding
- immediate reaction

Before I knew it...

き
気がつけば

Ki ga tsukeba.

Before I knew it...

Variants

- 気がつけば

Before I knew it...

- 気づけば

Before I realized it...

- ふと気がつけば

When I suddenly realized it...

- 気がついたら

Then I realized...

Adjusted Expression

いしき じかん けいか あと き
意識しないまま時間が経過し、後になってそのことに気づきました。

Time passed without my noticing it, and I only became aware of it afterward.

Example

A 「もうこんな時間？」 B 「うん。気がつけば三時間ずっとやってた」

A: Is it this late already? B: Yeah. Before I knew it, I'd been at it for three hours.

Notes

'Ki ga tsukeba' is used when speakers become aware that time has passed or a situation has changed while they were not consciously noticing it. 'Ki ga tsuku' refers to becoming aware of something, and although '-ba' is formally a conditional form, 'ki ga tsukeba' does not necessarily express an ordinary hypothetical condition. Instead, it can establish a temporal relationship roughly meaning that by the time the speaker became aware of the situation, a certain state had already come about. Thus, in an utterance such as 'ki ga tsukeba sanjikan tatte ita,' the speaker was not consciously tracking those three hours as they passed. The passage of time is discovered retrospectively from the present moment. The expression can overlap with 'itsu no ma ni ka,' but 'ki ga tsukeba' more clearly foregrounds the speaker's moment of realization. In the example, B has remained absorbed in an activity and then becomes aware of the current time, retrospectively recognizing that three hours have passed.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when the speaker realizes afterward that time has passed or a situation has changed without being consciously noticed

expression marking a moment when the speaker steps out of an ongoing activity or state and becomes aware of the current situation

expression presenting previously unnoticed passage of time or change as a discovery

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

realization

passage of time

situational change

discovery

retrospection

More than I expected

おも
思ったより

Omotta yori.

More than I expected.

Variants

- おも 思ったより
More than I expected.
- おも 思ってたより
More than I thought.
- おも 思ったよりも
More than I'd expected.
- よそう 予想してたより
More than I was expecting.

Adjusted Expression

じっさい けっか じぜん よそう こと
実際の結果は、事前に予想していたものとは異なっていました。

The actual result differed from what I had expected beforehand.

Example

A 「ここまで来るの、時間かかった？」 B 「いや、おも 思ったより はや つ 早く着いたよ」

A: Did it take you long to get here? B: No, I arrived here earlier than I expected.

Notes

'Omotta yori' is used when speakers evaluate an actual result by comparing it with an expectation they had beforehand. The content of 'omotta' is usually left unstated: what the speaker expected and to what degree are recovered from the situation and from the expression that follows. For example, 'omotta yori hayaku tsuita' implies that the speaker had expected the journey to take longer. Upon arriving, the speaker recognizes a difference between that prior expectation and the actual result and evaluates the arrival as earlier than expected. The expression therefore involves a temporal sequence: an earlier expectation, an actual experience, recognition of the difference between them, and a present evaluation. 'Omotteta yori' is the conversational form of 'omotte ita yori' and is especially common in everyday speech. In English, the comparative changes according to what is being evaluated, as in 'earlier than I expected,' 'more useful than I expected,' or 'easier than I thought,' whereas Japanese can place 'omotta yori' before a wide range of evaluations such as 'hayai,' 'benri,' or 'kantan.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression evaluating an actual result by comparing it with an earlier expectation

expression indicating an immediately recognized difference between what was expected and what actually happened

expression allowing the content and degree of the earlier expectation to remain implicit and be recovered from context

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

expectation

comparison

evaluation

result

realization

Oh, that one.

あ、そっちね

A, socchi ne.

Oh, that one.

Variants

- あ、そっちね
Oh, that one.
- ああ、そっちね
Oh, you mean that one.
- そっちね
That one, right.
- あ、そっちの^{はなし}話ね
Oh, that's what you're talking about.

Adjusted Expression

ああ、そちらのことだったのですね。

Oh, I see. You meant that one.

Example

A 「結婚のお許し、お父さん、怒るだろうか？」 B 「まあ、普通はそうだろう」 A 「あれ、お父さん、踊り出しちゃった」 B 「あ、そっちね」

A: Do you think my father will get angry when you ask for permission to marry me? B: Well, normally he would. A: Huh? My father's started dancing. B: Oh, that kind of reaction.

Notes

'A, socchi ne' is used at the moment when speakers realize that, among several possibilities, the relevant object, topic, interpretation, reaction, or development is different from the one they had initially assumed. 'A' marks the instant of recognition and switching. 'Socchi' is originally a demonstrative referring to a direction or object away from the speaker and toward the listener, but in conversation it can point not only to physical directions but also to discourse alternatives, interpretations, and even possible directions in which events may develop. 'Ne' accepts the newly identified alternative as something now shared between the speakers. For example, if the speaker assumes that 'what happened yesterday' refers to a meeting but is then told that it refers to another matter, 'A, socchi ne' switches the discourse referent. In the example here, however, the speakers expect the father to react angrily to a request for permission to marry, but he unexpectedly starts dancing. 'Socchi' does not refer to a physical object or topic; it points to an alternative direction of reaction: delight rather than anger. The expression can therefore mark an immediate switch from expected development A to actual development B. In this use, it can also carry a lightly humorous sense of recognizing and accepting an unexpected turn of events.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when the speaker realizes that the other person was referring to a different option from the one the speaker had assumed and immediately switches the referent

expression used when events take a different direction from the reaction or development the speaker had expected and the speaker recognizes and accepts that unexpected alternative

expression marking an immediate switch in the direction of reference, topic, interpretation, reaction, or development

colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- demonstrative
- reference
- referent switching
- expectation
- unexpected development
- development
- reinterpretation
- immediate reaction

Just in case

ねん
念のため

Nen no tame.

Just in case.

Variants

- ^{ねん}念のため

Just in case.

- ^{ねん}念のために

To be on the safe side.

- まあ、^{ねん}念のため

Well, just in case.

- ^{いちおう}一応、^{ねん}念のため

Just to be safe.

Adjusted Expression

^{もんだい}問題はないと思いますが、^{おも}万一に^{まんいち}備えて^{そな}準備して^{じゅんび}おきます。

I do not expect a problem, but I will prepare for the possibility just in case.

Example

A 「^{しりょう}資料、^{めーる}メールで^{おく}送ったよね？」 B 「うん。でも、^{ねん}念のためUSBにも^い入れておく」

A: You sent the materials by email, right? B: Yeah, but I'll put them on a USB drive too, just in case.

Notes

'Nen no tame' is used when speakers believe that things are probably fine but do not completely exclude the possibility of an unexpected problem and therefore take an additional precaution. The possible problem does not need to be stated explicitly because it can usually be inferred from the preceding conversation or immediate situation. For example, even if materials have already been sent by email, a speaker may also save them on a USB drive in case of a communication problem or file issue. The speaker is not necessarily predicting that something will go wrong. Rather, the expression responds to a small remaining uncertainty: things will probably be fine, but they are not completely certain. 'Nen no tame' therefore turns a slight reservation about the current situation into an additional preventive action.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when the speaker takes an additional action despite believing that things are probably fine

expression indicating preventive action in anticipation of a possible future problem without explicitly stating what that problem might be

expression adding an action for safety even though its necessity has not been established

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

precaution

uncertainty

additional action

safety check

anticipation

Oh, scratch that.

あ、^{いま}今のなし

A, ima no nashi.

Oh, scratch that.

Variants

- あ、^{いま}今のなし

Oh, scratch that.

- ^{いま}今のなし

Scratch that.

- ごめん、^{いま}今のなし

Sorry, scratch that.

- あ、^{いま}今のなしね

Never mind what I just said.

Adjusted Expression

^{いま}今の^{はつげん}発言は^と取り^け消します。

I withdraw what I just said.

Example

A 「じゃあ、^{あした}明日の^じ3時に...あ、^{いま}今のなし。^じ4時だった」

A: Okay, then tomorrow at three..., oh, scratch that. It was four.

Notes

'A, ima no nashi' is used when speakers realize immediately after speaking that what they have just said contains a mistake, misunderstanding, inappropriate remark, or other problem, and they withdraw that utterance on the spot. 'A' marks the moment when the speaker detects the problem, often as a result of hearing their own utterance. 'Ima no' points to the utterance that has just been produced, while 'nashi' indicates that it should no longer be treated as valid in the ongoing interaction. The expression therefore displays a clear temporal sequence: an utterance is produced, a problem is detected, the utterance is revoked, and a correction may follow. In the example, the speaker first says 'three,' immediately realizes that this is wrong, cancels it with 'A, ima no nashi,' and then replaces it with 'four.' The expression can be expanded into a complete sentence such as 'I withdraw what I just said,' but 'A, ima no nashi' functions independently as an immediate act of revoking the preceding utterance rather than merely as an incomplete version of a fuller sentence.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when speakers immediately realize that something they have just said is wrong or inappropriate and withdraw it

expression treating the immediately preceding utterance as an object and revoking it on the spot

expression used after detecting a mistake, misunderstanding, or inappropriate remark and before moving on to a correction

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

self-correction

retraction

utterance cancellation

repair

metalinguistic utterance

immediate reaction

Since we're here...

せっかくだから

Sekkaku dakara.

Since we're here...

Variants

- せっかくだから
Since we're here...
- せっかくだし
Since we have the chance...
- せっかくなので
While we have the opportunity...
- せっかく^き来たんだから
Since we've come all this way...

Adjusted Expression

この^き機会^{かい}を生^いかして、もう一つ^{ひと}行動^{こうどう}することにしましょう。

Since we have this opportunity, let's make use of it and do something more.

Example

A 「この^{ちか}近くに^{ゆうめい}有名な^わ和菓子^が屋^しがあるよ」 B 「じゃあ、せっかくだから^よ寄って
いこうか」

A: There's a famous Japanese sweets shop near here. B: Since we're here, we might as well stop by.

Notes

'Sekkaku dakara' is used when speakers recognize that a situation or opportunity already available to them would be a waste not to make use of, and they decide on an additional action as a result. 'Sekkaku' assigns value to the current opportunity or circumstances. That value may come from the rarity of the opportunity or from the time and effort already spent reaching the present situation. 'Dakara' then turns that valued situation into a reason for what the speaker proposes to do next. The expression therefore involves an immediate reevaluation of the current circumstances: since this opportunity is already available, it would be a shame not to make use of it. In the example, the speakers are already in the area when they learn that a famous Japanese sweets shop is nearby. B treats being there as an opportunity and immediately proposes stopping by. Depending on the situation, English may use expressions such as 'since we're here,' 'since we have the chance,' or 'we might as well,' rather than a single fixed equivalent for 'sekkaku dakara.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used to decide on an additional action rather than waste an opportunity or situation that has already arisen

expression treating the current situation as valuable and using that value as a reason for the next action

expression marking an immediate decision to make use of an opportunity or of time and effort already invested

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

opportunity

situational judgment

additional action

reason

making use of an opportunity

Oh, now I get it.

あ、^{いま}今わかった

A, ima wakatta.

Oh, now I get it.

Variants

- あ、^{いま}今わかった

Oh, now I get it.

- ああ、^{いま}今わかった

Ah, now I understand.

- ^{いま}今わかった

Now I get it.

- あ、やっとわかった

Oh, I finally get it.

Adjusted Expression

ああ、^{いま}今ようやく^{り かい}理解できました。

Oh, I understand it now.

Example

A 「だから、この二つは^{ふた}別々に^{べつべつ}数える^{かず}んじゃなくて、一組で^{ひとくみ}一つ^{ひと}なんだよ」 B
「あ、^{いま}今わかった」

A: So you don't count these two separately. Together, they make one unit.

B: Oh, now I get it.

Notes

'A, ima wakatta' is used when something that the speaker had not understood becomes clear at that very moment as a result of the immediately preceding explanation or clue. 'A' marks the instant of a change in recognition, while 'ima' does more than indicate the present time: it marks the boundary between a state of not understanding and a newly achieved state of understanding. 'Wakatta' here is therefore not merely a report of the speaker's cognitive state. It functions as an immediate reaction to the transition into understanding itself. The expression has a clear temporal structure: non-understanding, receipt of a clue, emergence of understanding, and immediate reaction. In the example, the explanation that the two items should be treated as one unit causes the previously unclear idea to fall into place, prompting the response 'Oh, now I get it.' The shorter 'A, wakatta' can also mark understanding, but adding 'ima' explicitly highlights the moment at which the change occurs. 'A, yatto wakatta,' by contrast, adds the implication that reaching understanding took some time or effort.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when something that had not been understood becomes clear at that very moment because of the immediately preceding explanation or clue

expression marking the moment of transition from not understanding to understanding

expression indicating that newly received information has just caused previously disconnected pieces of information to fall into place

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

understanding

realization

state change

recognition

time

immediate reaction

What? I have absolutely no intention of doing that.

え、そんなつもり、さらさらない

E, sonna tsumori, sarasara nai.

What? I have absolutely no intention of doing that.

Variants

- え、そんなつもり、さらさらない

What? I have absolutely no intention of doing that.

- そんなつもり、さらさらない

I have absolutely no intention of doing that.

- いや、そんなつもり、さらさらない

No, I have absolutely no intention of doing that.

- そんなつもりはさらさらない

I have no intention whatsoever of doing that.

Adjusted Expression

わたし 私には、そのような意図いとはまったくありません。

I have absolutely no such intention.

Example

A 「その仕事しごと、結局けっきょく引き受けるつもりなんでしょ？」 B 「え、そんなつもり、さらさらない」

A: You're going to take that job after all, aren't you? B: What? I have absolutely no intention of doing that.

Notes

'E, sonna tsumori, sarasara nai' is an immediate expression used when speakers strongly reject another person's assumption about their intention or plan. 'E' marks immediate surprise at the assumption. 'Sonna tsumori' refers to the intention that the listener has attributed to the speaker. 'Sarasara nai' expresses a strong form of negation, roughly meaning 'not at all' or 'not in the slightest,' and can imply that the speaker never had such an intention in the first place. The expression is therefore stronger than simply saying 'sonna tsumori wa nai' and clearly rejects the listener's interpretation. In the example, the speaker is assumed to be planning to take on a particular job and immediately responds with surprise and emphatic denial.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately and strongly rejecting another person's assumption about the speaker's intention or plan

expression emphasizing that the speaker has had no such intention at all

expression using 'sonna tsumori' to identify the intention assumed by the listener and 'sarasara nai' to reject it completely

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

strong negation

denial of intention

rejection of assumption

evaluation

immediate reaction

Not so fast!

ちよつと待^まったあ！

Chotto mattaa!

Not so fast!

Variants

- ちよつと待^まったあ！

Not so fast!

- ちよつと待^まった！

Wait a second!

- 待^まった待^まった！

Hold it!

- おい、ちよつと待^まった！

Hey, wait a minute!

Adjusted Expression

少し待^まってください。そのまま進^{すす}めないでください。

Please wait a moment. Do not proceed yet.

Example

A 「じゃあ、この案^{あん}で決^け定^{てい}ということで」 B 「ちよつと待^まったあ！ その数^{すう}字^じ、
まだ確^{かく}認^{にん}してないよ」

A: Okay, then let's go with this proposal. B: Not so fast! We haven't checked those numbers yet.

Notes

'Chotto mattaa!' is an immediate expression used to forcefully interrupt and stop the listener just as their speech, action, or decision is about to move forward. Unlike No.315, 'Chotto matte,' which primarily functions as a request for someone to wait briefly, 'Chotto mattaa!' more strongly halts an ongoing process so that the speaker can insert a check, objection, or correction. Although 'matta' has the form of the past tense of 'matsu' (to wait), it does not describe a past event here. Instead, it functions as an immediate intervention. Lengthening the final vowel in 'mattaa!' adds force and makes the interruption sound more emphatic. In the example, just as a proposal is about to be accepted, B remembers that some figures have not yet been checked and interrupts with 'Chotto mattaa!' to stop the decision from going through.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression forcefully interrupting the listener at the moment their speech or action is about to proceed

expression temporarily stopping a decision or ongoing process in order to insert a check or objection

expression indicating that the listener should not simply continue, rather than merely asking them to wait

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

stopping

interruption

objection

halting progress

immediate reaction

I hate to say this, but...

こう^い言っちゃんただけど

Kou iccha nan da kedo.

I hate to say this, but...

Variants

- こう^い言っちゃんただけど
I hate to say this, but...
- こう^い言うのもただけど
It's a little awkward to say this, but...
- こんなこと言っちゃんただけど
I probably shouldn't say this, but...
- こう^い言ってはなんだけど
I don't mean to sound rude, but...

Adjusted Expression

このようなことを自分^{じぶん}で言うのは少し^{すこ}気が引^きけますが、

I feel a little hesitant to say this myself, but...

Example

A 「どう？」 B 「こう^い言っちゃんただけど、私^{わたし}が作^{つく}るといいね」

A: What do you think? B: I hate to say this, but it turns out pretty well when I make it.

Notes

'Kou iccha nan da kedo' is used when speakers feel some hesitation about what they are about to say and signal that hesitation before stating the content itself. 'Kou iccha' is the colloquial form of 'kou itte wa' and anticipates the speaker's own upcoming utterance. The 'nan' in 'nan da kedo' does not specify exactly what is problematic. It may involve possible rudeness, self-praise, overstatement, awkwardness, or some other reason for hesitation. Instead of naming that reason, the expression leaves it vague and moves directly into the following statement. This vagueness allows the speaker to create a soft entry into something difficult to say without giving a full apology or explanation. Unlike No.690, 'Kyu ni konna koto kiku no mo, are, nan da kedo, ...', which softens the awkwardness of introducing a sudden question, 'Kou iccha nan da kedo' marks hesitation about the content of the speaker's own upcoming statement. In the example, B feels slightly awkward about praising something they made themselves, so they preface the self-evaluation with 'Kou iccha nan da kedo' before saying that it turns out well when they make it.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression signaling in advance that what the speaker is about to say feels difficult or awkward to say

expression softly introducing criticism, self-evaluation, or another potentially uncomfortable statement

expression leaving the exact reason for the hesitation unstated while moving into the following utterance

colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- preface
- hesitation
- mitigation
- difficulty saying something
- self-commentary

Oh, that changes things.

あ、それなら話は別^{はなし べつ}

A, sore nara hanashi wa betsu.

Oh, that changes things.

Variants

- それなら話は別^{はなし べつ}

That changes things.

- あ、それなら別^{べつ}

Oh, that's different, then.

- それなら話が違^{はなし ちが}う

Well, that's a different story.

- あ、それなら話^{はなし}が^か変わってくる

Oh, in that case, things are different.

Adjusted Expression

あ、それでしたら話^{はなし べつ}は別です

Oh, in that case, that changes things.

Example

A「日曜日^{にちようび}、ちょっと手伝^{てつだ}ってくれない？」 B「日曜^{にちよう}はちょっと…」 A「お昼^{ひる}はうなぎ、ごちそうするよ」 B「あ、それなら話^{はなし べつ}は別」

A: Could you give me a hand on Sunday? B: Sunday's a little difficult... A: I'll treat you to eel for lunch. B: **Oh, that changes things.**

Notes

"A, sore nara hanashi wa betsu" is used when newly supplied information changes the speaker's judgment on the spot. "Sore nara" immediately takes the preceding information as a new condition, while "hanashi wa betsu" signals that the situation must now be evaluated differently. Here, "hanashi" does not literally mean a story or conversation; it refers more broadly to the matter under consideration. The expression is often used lightly or humorously when an unexpected favorable condition changes the speaker's attitude.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

to immediately revise one's judgment after receiving new information or a new condition

to take the preceding remark as a new premise and update one's view of the situation

to lightly signal a change of attitude after learning an unexpected favorable or important detail

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

reaction

condition

judgment update

Actually, never mind.

あ、やっぱやめた

A, yappa yameta.

Actually, never mind.

Variants

- あ、やっぱやめた
Actually, never mind.
- いや、やっぱやめた
No, never mind.
- やっぱ、やめとく
I think I'll skip it after all.
- あ、やめた
Never mind.

Adjusted Expression

かんが なお
考え直して、やめることにしました。

I reconsidered and decided not to do it.

Example

A 「か れ ーカレーにする？」 B 「うん。あ、やっぱやめた。そ ばそばにする」

A: Are you going to have the curry? B: Yeah. Actually, never mind. I'll have the soba.

Notes

'A, yappa yameta' is used when speakers have just chosen something or decided to do something but reconsider immediately before carrying it out and withdraw that choice or action on the spot. 'A' marks the moment when the change of mind occurs. 'Yappa,' the conversational form of 'yappari,' connects the new decision with the speaker's immediately preceding judgment or with an alternative that had already been present in the background. Although 'yameta' has past-tense form, it does not primarily report an earlier event here. Instead, it performs a decision at the present moment: the speaker has now decided not to proceed. The expression therefore contains a short temporal sequence: a choice is made, reconsideration occurs just before execution, the choice is withdrawn, and the speaker shifts to another course of action. In the example, B initially chooses curry but changes their mind before ordering, says 'A, yappa yameta,' and switches to soba.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when the speaker reconsiders and immediately withdraws something they had just chosen or intended to do

expression canceling a choice or action just before it is carried out

expression marking an immediate change from the speaker's preceding decision to a new course of action

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

withdrawal

change of choice

reconsideration

change of action

immediate reaction

Oh, this might work.

あ、いけそう

A, ikesou.

Oh, this might work.

Variants

- あ、いけそう
Oh, this might work.
- お、いけそう
Hey, this might work.
- これ、いけそう
This might work.
- あ、これならいけそう
Oh, this looks like it might work.

Adjusted Expression

ほうほう
この方法なら、うまくいきそうです。

It looks as though this method may work.

Example

A 「それ、はい入る？」 B 「うーん...あ、いけそう」

A: Will that fit? B: Hmm... oh, this might work.

Notes

'A, ikesou' is an immediate expression used during an attempt when speakers realize that success has not yet been achieved but now appears possible from the current situation or feedback. 'A' marks the moment when the speaker notices the possibility of success. Here, 'ikeru' does not mean being able to go somewhere; it means that a method may work or that something may be feasible. 'Sou' indicates a judgment based on what the speaker can currently observe, before the result has been confirmed. For this reason, 'A, ikesou' does not report success itself. It expresses an immediate prediction made when signs of possible success appear during an ongoing attempt. Unlike No.853, 'A, iketa,' which confirms that an attempt has actually succeeded, 'A, ikesou' belongs to the immediately preceding stage, when the speaker judges that success now looks likely. In the example, the speaker is trying to fit something into a space and, after making an adjustment, realizes that it may now fit and responds, 'A, ikesou.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately used when the speaker realizes during an attempt that success now seems possible

expression judging on the spot, before success is achieved, that the current situation or feedback indicates a good chance of success

expression leaving what seems likely to succeed unstated because it is shared in the situation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

possibility

prediction

attempt

prediction of success

immediate judgment

Oh, you're right.

あ、ほんとだ

A, *honto da.*

Oh, you're right.

Variants

- あ、ほんとだ
Oh, you're right.
- ほんとだ
You're right.
- あ、ほんとだね
Oh, that's true.
- あ、^{ほんとう}本当ですね
Oh, you're right about that.

Adjusted Expression

^{かくにん}確認したところ、^{たし}確かにそのとおりでした。

I checked, and it was indeed as you said.

Example

A 「それなら、^{せんしゅう}先週、^{べんきょう}勉強したよ」 B 「あ、ほんとだ」

A: In that case, we studied it last week. B: Oh, you're right.

Notes

'A, honto da' is an immediate expression used after the listener points something out and the speaker checks it for themselves and realizes that it is indeed true. 'A' marks the moment when the speaker's new understanding is established through confirmation. 'Honto da' does not simply accept the listener's statement as an opinion; it indicates that the speaker has compared the statement with the available facts or evidence and has independently recognized it as true. For this reason, the expression differs from a general agreement such as 'Sou desu ne.' It specifically conveys the sense of 'I just checked, and now I see that it really is true.' What has been confirmed does not need to be repeated because it is clear from the immediately preceding utterance. In the example, a previously registered expression is almost treated as a new candidate, but after being told that it already exists as No.854, the speaker checks and immediately responds, 'A, honto da.' The expression itself arose naturally during the AEAD work.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately used when the speaker checks the listener's observation and realizes that it is in fact true

expression confirming on the spot that the listener's statement matches the observable facts rather than merely agreeing with it

expression incorporating the listener's statement into the speaker's own newly established understanding

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

confirmation

discovery

fact checking

revision of understanding

immediate reaction

Yeah, I kind of figured.

うすうす、^き気づいてた

Ususu, kizuiteta.

Yeah, I kind of figured.

Variants

- うすうす^き気づいてた
I kind of figured.
- まあ、うすうす^き気づいてた
Yeah, I sort of knew.
- なんとなく^き気づいてた
I had a feeling.
- ^{じつ}実は、うすうす^き気づいてた
Actually, I'd kind of figured.

Adjusted Expression

^{いぜん}以前から、なんとなくそうではないかと^き気づいていました。

I had already had a vague sense that this might be the case.

Example

A 「わたしたち、^つ付き^あ合ってるんです」 B 「うん、うすうす、^き気づいてた」

A: We're seeing each other. B: Yeah, I kind of figured.

Notes

"Ususu, kizuiteta" is used when a fact is explicitly revealed and the speaker indicates that they had already weakly suspected or sensed it beforehand. "Ususu" does not simply mean "a little"; it suggests that the speaker had picked up on various signs or clues but had not yet reached full certainty. Once the other person states the fact clearly, the speaker's previously uncertain awareness becomes confirmed, and the speaker can retrospectively say that they had already noticed something was going on. In the example, the speaker had sensed from the couple's behavior that they might be together, but the matter remained unconfirmed until they said so directly. The initial "un" signals calm acceptance rather than surprise, fitting a situation in which the information was already partly expected. "Nantonaku kizuiteta" is similar, but "ususu" more strongly suggests that weak awareness had gradually formed from accumulating signs.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when a fact is explicitly revealed and the speaker says they had already weakly suspected it

expression indicating that an earlier uncertain impression or suspicion has just been confirmed by new information

expression immediately linking a prior weak awareness with newly confirmed information

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

awareness

inference

prior awareness

confirmation

information update

immediate reaction

Actually, it's not that bad.

いがい へいき
意外と、平気

Igai to, heiki.

Actually, it's not that bad.

Variants

- いがい へいき
意外と平気

Actually, it's not that bad.

- いがい へいき
あ、意外と平気

Oh, it's not as bad as I thought.

- いがい だいじょうぶ
意外と大丈夫

Surprisingly, I'm fine.

- おも へいき
思ったより平気

I'm actually okay.

Adjusted Expression

じっさい ため おも もんだい
実際に試してみると、思っていたほど問題ありません。

Now that I've tried it, it isn't as bad as I expected.

Example

A 「^{から}辛い？」 B 「うん、^{いがい}意外と、^{へいき}平気」

A: Isn't it spicy? B: Actually, it's not that bad.

Notes

"Igai to, heiki" is used when direct experience shows that something is less difficult, unpleasant, or troublesome than the speaker had expected. Here, "igai to" does more than describe an outcome as unexpected: it marks a discrepancy between a prior expectation and the speaker's present experience. In the example, the speaker expects the food to be quite spicy, tries it, and discovers that it is not as bad as anticipated. The expression immediately updates that earlier evaluation. "Heiki" can be used not only for spiciness but also for pain, cold, nervousness, difficulty, and other situations that were expected to cause discomfort or trouble. "Omotta yori heiki" is similar, but "igai to" allows the speaker to signal the mismatch between expectation and experience without explicitly stating what the earlier expectation was.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used when direct experience shows that something is less problematic than expected

expression used to update an evaluation by contrasting a prior expectation with the speaker's present experience

expression indicating on the spot that something is less difficult, unpleasant, or troublesome than anticipated

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

adverb

expectation

unexpected result

evaluation update

direct experience

immediate reaction

Oh, that table just opened up.

あ、そこ^あ空いた

A, soko aita.

Oh, that table just opened up.

Variants

- あ、そこ^あ空いた
Oh, that table just opened up.
- あ、^あ空いた
Oh, a spot opened up.
- そこ^あ空いたよ
That spot's free now.
- あ、あそこ^あ空いた
Oh, there's a table free over there.

Adjusted Expression

あそこに^あ空いている^{せき}席ができました。

A table has just become available over there.

Example

A 「ぜんぜん^あ空いてないね」 B 「あ、そこ^あ空いた」

A: There aren't any tables free. B: Oh, that table just opened up.

Notes

'A, soko aita' is an immediate expression used when the speaker is looking for an available place and suddenly notices that a previously occupied or unavailable spot has become free. 'A' marks the instant of discovery. 'Soko' points to a location that both participants can identify within the shared visual situation, while 'aita' indicates that the place has just become available. The speaker does not need to say 'seat' or 'table' explicitly because the shared situation supplies that information. In a crowded food court, for example, both speakers can immediately understand what 'soko' refers to. The utterance is also more than a simple report of a state. Once the speaker says 'A, soko aita,' a next action such as moving toward the table can follow almost automatically. The expression therefore links environmental scanning, detection of a change of state, reference, joint attention, and immediate action. Although 'aita' is morphologically past tense, it does not function here as a retrospective report. It marks a newly established state that the speaker has just detected.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression immediately announcing that a previously unavailable place has become available

expression used when the speaker detects a change in the environment while actively looking for an available place

expression leaving the exact type of place unstated because it is identifiable from the shared situation

expression that can immediately trigger a next action such as moving toward the newly available place

colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- discovery
- change of state
- availability
- demonstrative
- joint attention
- next action
- immediate reaction

That's a bit much.

さすがに、それはない

Sasuga ni, sore wa nai.

That's a bit much.

Variants

- さすがに、それはない
That's a bit much.
- いや、さすがにそれはない
Come on, that's too much.
- それはさすがにない
That's really pushing it.
- さすがにそこまでは
I wouldn't go that far.

Adjusted Expression

それは、さすがに許容^{きょよう}できる範囲^{はんい}を越^こえています。

That goes beyond what I can reasonably accept.

Example

A 「あれ、支払い済み？ 田中さん、みんなの分も払ってくれたかな？」 B 「いやいや、さすがに、それはない」

A: Wait, has everything been paid? Did Tanaka pay for everyone too? B: Come on, that's a bit much.

Notes

"Sasuga ni, sore wa nai" is used when the speaker immediately judges that a newly proposed action or condition goes beyond an acceptable limit. In this use, "sasuga ni" does not mean that something lives up to its reputation. Instead, it marks a boundary: something might be acceptable up to a certain point, but this particular case crosses that line. "Sore wa nai" does not literally mean that something does not exist; it evaluates the proposal as unreasonable, unacceptable, or too much. In the example, meeting itself may be acceptable, but five in the morning exceeds the speaker's limit, triggering an immediate negative judgment. A form such as "sasuga ni soko made wa" can express the same boundary even without stating the final predicate.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression used to judge on the spot that a proposal or action goes beyond an acceptable limit

expression indicating that something may be acceptable up to a point but has now crossed the line

expression used to give an immediate strongly negative evaluation of what was just proposed

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

adverb

limit

acceptable range

negative evaluation

immediate reaction

Colophon

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